

Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS)

Managed Care Review State Portal User Manual

Version 2.0

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1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 What is MC-Review

Managed Care Review (MC-Review) is an online managed care submission portal that streamlines and standardizes the submission of managed care health plan contracts and rates for states and facilitates CMS' intake and review of those submissions.

MC-Review replaces the need for states to complete the Contract and Rate Certification Cover Sheet document, as the information is collected through the online submission form instead.

1.2 What types of submissions and documents can be submitted in MC-Review

Effective July 1, 2026, you must use MC-Review to submit Medicaid and CHIP managed care health plan contracts and rates described below to CMS. This portal accepts:

- Base contracts and amendments with or without new rate certifications or rate amendments
- Contracts related to Dual Eligible Special Needs Plans (D-SNPs) with Medicaid-covered benefits
- Additional supporting documents related to contracts or rate certifications

Not accepted through MC-Review at this time:

- State directed preprints
- Contracts without Medicaid-covered benefits
- Some submissions related to programs for dual-eligible beneficiaries, such as Programs of All-Inclusive Care for the Elderly (PACE) and dual demonstration contracts
- Non-health plan submissions such as External Quality Review Organization (EQRO) or Enrollment Broker (EB)
- **Submissions that were started via email prior to July 1, 2026**. If your initial submission was transmitted via email, the remainder of that submission, including any additional or revised documents, must be submitted via email. A submission that began over email cannot be converted to a MC-Review submission. Please reach out to your DMCO Lead analyst and MCGDMCOActions@cms.hhs.gov if you have any questions.

2. Access and Settings

2.1 How to access MC-Review to view or submit a submission

You can access MC-Review by clicking on the previous link. You must have an account to use MC-Review. See How to add or create a new user account for more information.

We recommend accessing MC-Review through the following web browsers:

- Chrome
- Safari
- Edge

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- Firefox

The current and previous two versions of these browsers are supported by MC-Review. While MC-Review may work on other browsers and versions, other browsers including Internet Explorer and Opera are not actively supported.

We recommend that you access MC-Review on a laptop or desktop, as mobile phones and tablets may not provide an optimal experience.

2.2 How to add or create a new user account

In order to create a user account to log in and access MC-Review, you must sign up through CMS's Identify Management (IDM) System. The IDM System provides the means for users to be approved to access MC-Review and many other CMS systems and applications. IDM governs access to CMS systems by managing the creation of user IDs and passwords, setting up multi-factor authentication (MFA), and the assignment of roles within CMS applications.

If you already have an IDM account, you simply need to submit a request for a state user account for MC-Review. Once your account creation request has been approved, you can log in with your IDM credentials to MC-Review.

For detailed information on how to log in to IDM and create a user account, refer to the Identity Management System Instructions for State Users Guide.

2.3 User types and permissions

Currently, permissions for state users are the same for all users across a state.

As a state user, you can create new submissions for your state. You can also view, edit, or submit any submissions that you *or any other user in your state* has created. There is no limit on the number of state user accounts per state.

2.4 How to request access be revoked for a user

If an individual with a user account for your state should no longer have access to MC-Review, you can request that the account access be revoked.

To request an account to be revoked, email MC_Review_HelpDesk@cms.hhs.gov with the name and email address of the user.

Outside of requests for user permissions to be revoked, the MC-Review Team annually confirms and recertifies the list of individuals with state user accounts to ensure the right individuals continue to have access.

3. Viewing, creating, submitting, and editing submissions

3.1 Viewing and finding submissions in MC-Review

3.1.1 Submission Dashboard

Once a submission is created, it will be available for viewing on your state dashboard. Regardless of who started the submission, all draft or submitted submissions in your state will appear on the dashboard. Refer to *Figure 1*.

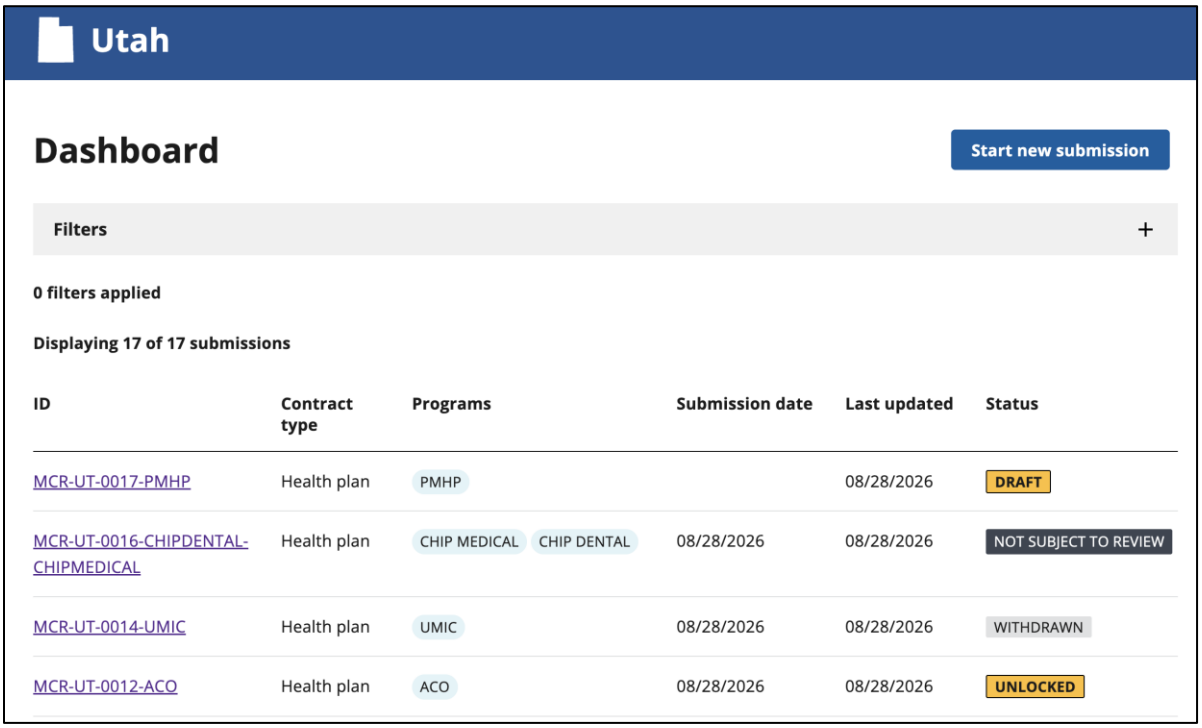


Figure 1: Submission Dashboard

3.1.2 Dashboard filtering

You are able to expand the filters box at the top of the dashboard, which will then allow you to filter the dashboard by Contract type, Programs, or Status. Refer to *Figure 2*.

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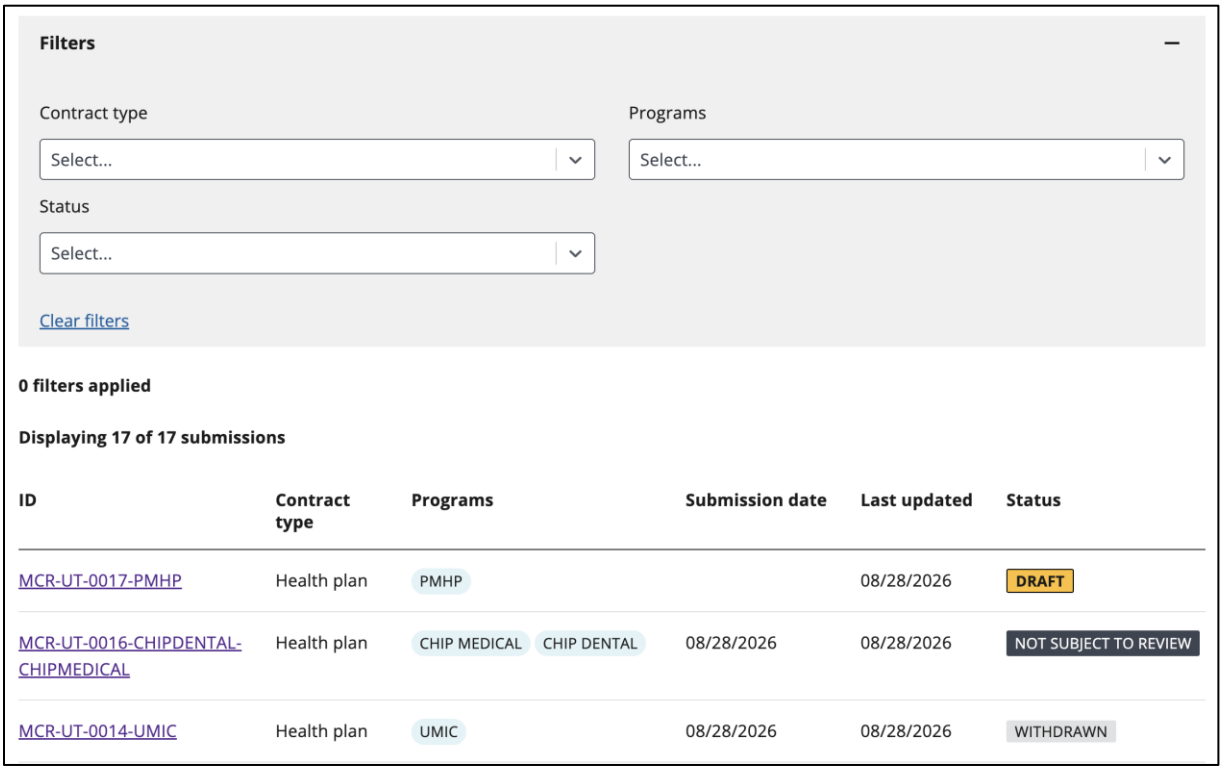


Figure 2: Submission Dashboard with Expanded Filters

Each of the filters includes a dropdown menu which will allow you to select from pre-defined options based upon the corresponding field. You can select as many options from each of the filters as you would like to refine what is displayed on the dashboard. Refer to *Figure 3*.

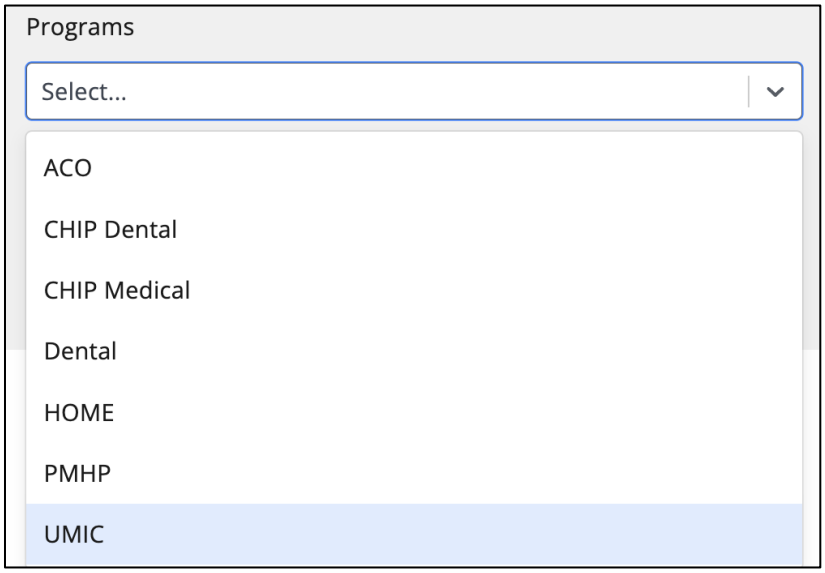


Figure 3: Programs Filter Dropdown Menu

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The dashboard will be updated based upon the filters which are selected. You can remove filters by clicking the “x” which is included at the right of the dropdown menu when a filter has been applied. Refer to *Figure 4*.

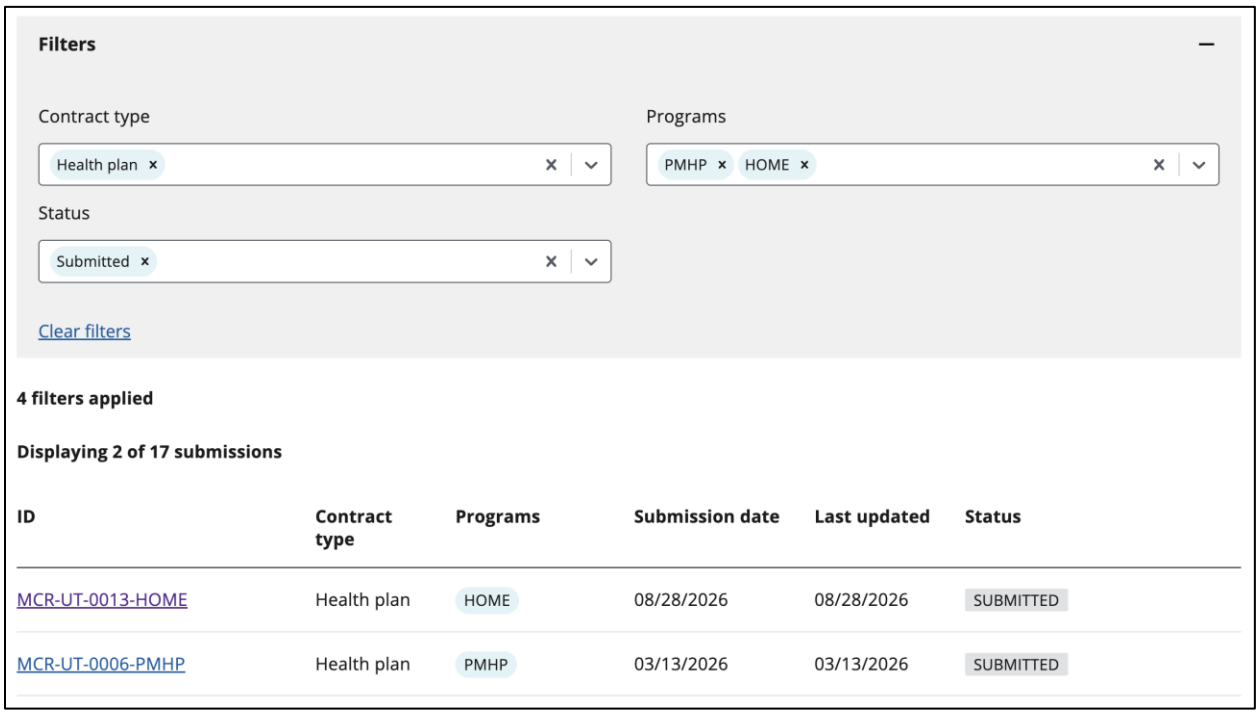


Figure 4: Submissions Dashboard with Filters Applied

3.1.3 Dashboard statuses

There are six statuses that can appear on your dashboard:

- **Draft**: A submission that is still in progress and has not yet been submitted to CMS for review. CMS staff cannot view, and do not have access to these submissions.
- **Submitted**: A submission that has been successfully sent to CMS for review. These submissions are locked and cannot be edited.
- **Unlocked**: A submission that has been unlocked by CMS to allow for changes to be made. See section, Making changes to a submission that has been submitted to CMS for details. CMS cannot see any changes completed in this status, until the submission is submitted back to CMS.
- **Withdrawn**: A submission that has been withdrawn and is no longer under review by CMS. See section, How to withdraw a submission for details.
- **Approved**: A submission that has been approved or closed by CMS. See section, Submission review and approval for details.
- **Not subject to review**: Displayed for CHIP-only submissions; this status reflects that the submission is not subject to DMCO review or validation.

3.2 Creating a new submission

To create a new submission in MC-Review, log into your state dashboard and select the “Start new submission” button. Refer to *Figure 5*.

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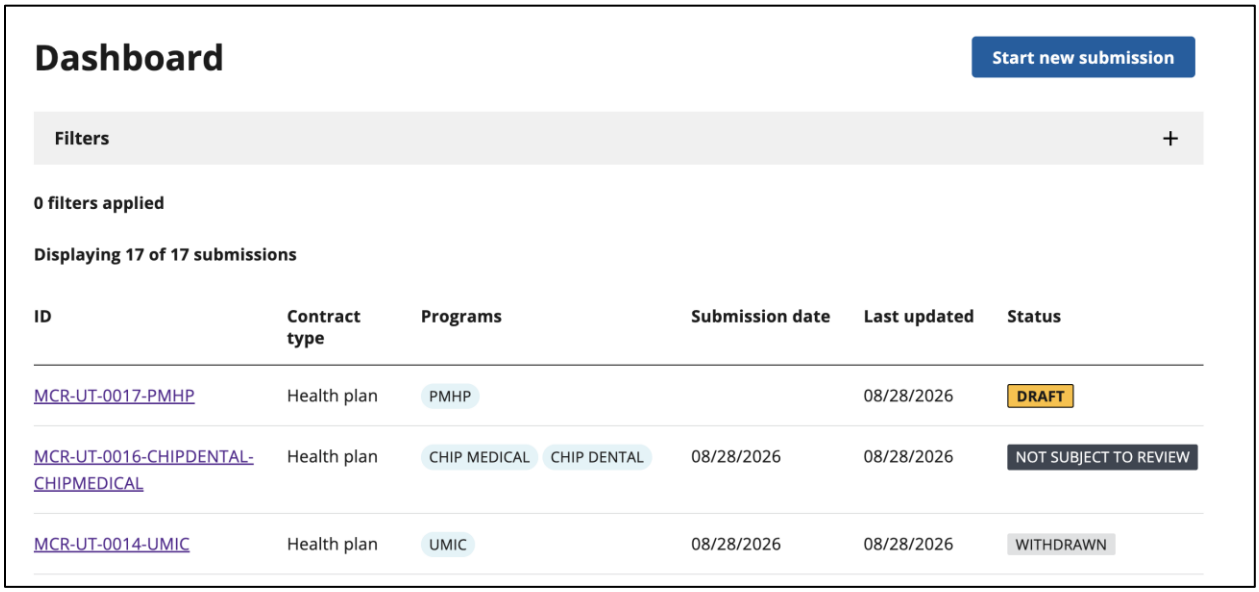


Figure 5: Start New Submission Button

The number of sections in the submission form that you will be required to complete prior to submitting will depend on the type of submission you are making to CMS.

The submission form includes the following sections:

- Submission type (required for all submissions)
- Contract details (required for all submissions; all submissions must include a contract)
- Rate details (only required for contract actions that require new or amended rate certifications)
- Contacts (required for all submissions)
- Supporting documents, if applicable

3.2.1 Submission type

On this portion of the form, you can enter some key information about the submission, including the population(s) and program(s) covered by the contract and the contract action type.

1. **Selecting the populations covered**

   You can select whether the populations covered are Medicaid, Medicaid and CHIP, or CHIP-only. Refer to *Figure 6*.

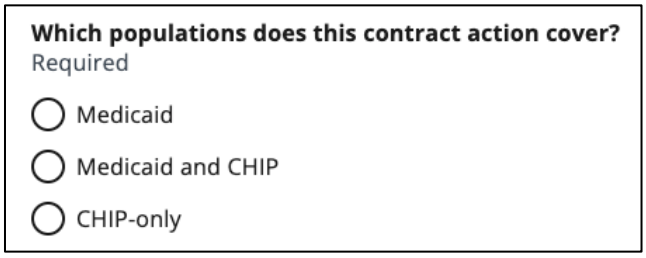


Figure 6: Populations Covered Question

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Currently, MC-Review does not accept rate certifications when the population covered by the contract action is CHIP-only. At this time, rate related documentation for CHIP-only contracts can be uploaded as contract supporting documents.

When the selection made for "Which populations does this contract action cover?" is CHIP-only, you will not be able to select "Contract action and rate certification" for the "Choose a submission type" field. Refer to *Figure 7*.

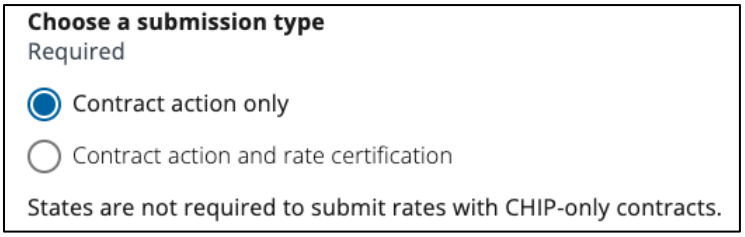


Figure 7: Submission Type Question when CHIP-Only has Been Selected

2. **Selecting your managed care state programs**

When making a submission in MC-Review, you will be required to select the managed care state program(s) which are applicable to your contract action from a pre-set list on the "Submission type" page. Refer to *Figure 8*.

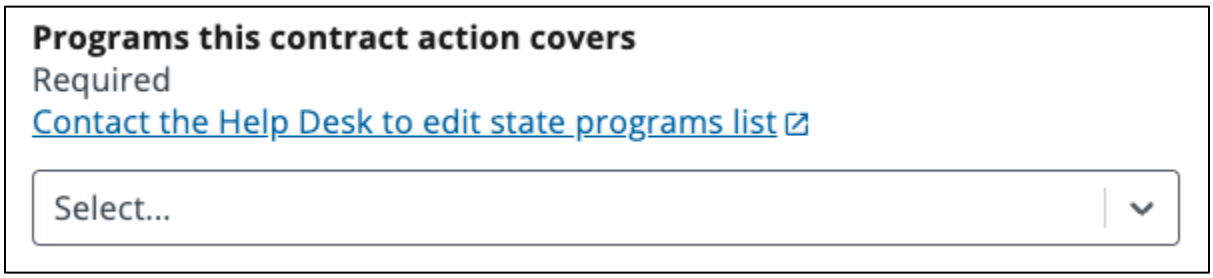


Figure 8: Programs the Contract Action Covers Dropdown

States should select only the programs which are directly impacted by the submission.

- **Example 1**: You are submitting a base contract that includes two programs and three rate programs. You will select all programs and rate programs from the dropdown menu.
- **Example 2**: You are submitting an amendment to the base contract referenced in Example 1, but you are only changing contract provisions and a rate that impacts a single population. You should select the one program and one rate program which is being modified in the agreement.

If you do not see the correct state programs in this list, contact the help desk at MC_Review_HelpDesk@cms.hhs.gov with the name of the state program and the requested action to be taken (i.e. to add the program, remove the program, or edit the name of an existing program). Please obtain concurrence from all state users of CMS systems, reports and tools (for example, Medicaid Data Collection Tool (MDCT) for MLR, MCPAR, and NAAAR submissions, and the managed care enrollment report, etc.) before requesting a change as if approved, a change request will be implemented in all managed care systems and tools. State programs will not appear in the pre-set list if

their corresponding submission types are out of scope (see section, What types of submissions and documents can be submitted in MC-Review).

3. **Submission type**

   You will need to indicate whether the submission is for a contract action only or for both a contract action and rate certification. The rate details portion of the form will only be displayed when the submission type selection is contract action and rate certification. Refer to *Figure 9*.

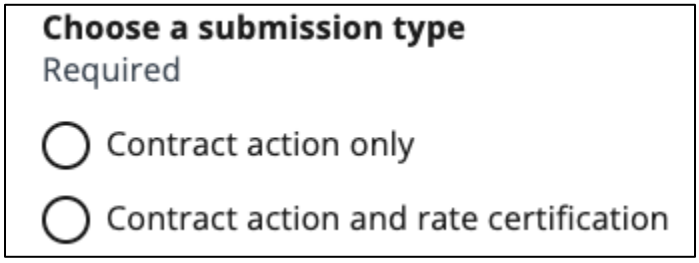


Figure 9: Submission Type Question

   For instances where a new rate is not being submitted, but the contract needs to be associated with a rate certification which was previously submitted to CMS via MC-Review with a different contract submission, then "Contract action and rate certification" should be selected. This will allow you to link the contract action to the previously submitted rate. For additional detail on when to associate a previously submitted rate, see Yes, this rate certification is part of another submission.

4. **Contract action type**

   You will need to indicate whether the submission is for a base contract or an amendment to a base contract. Refer to *Figure 10*.

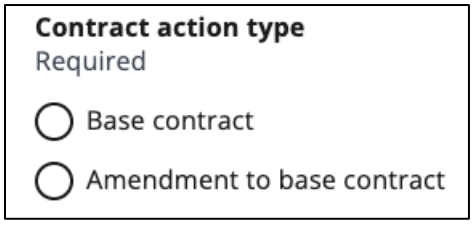


Figure 10: Contract Action Type Question

5. **Is this a risk-based contract?**

   You will need to indicate whether or not the submission is for a risk-based contract based on 42 CFR § 438.2. Refer to *Figure 11*.

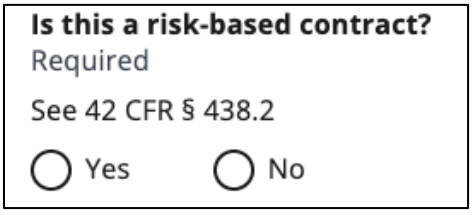


Figure 11: Risk-Based Contract Question

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6. **Submission description**

The submission description entered into the form should provide a high-level summary of the action being submitted, and include enough information for CMS and State users to understand the purpose of the submission. At minimum this should include the name of the contract, contract period, and brief description of the action. For contract amendment submissions, this description should also include the contract amendment number, and a high-level description of any language updates. If there are rates associated with this submission, they should also be described here. Refer to *Figure 12*.

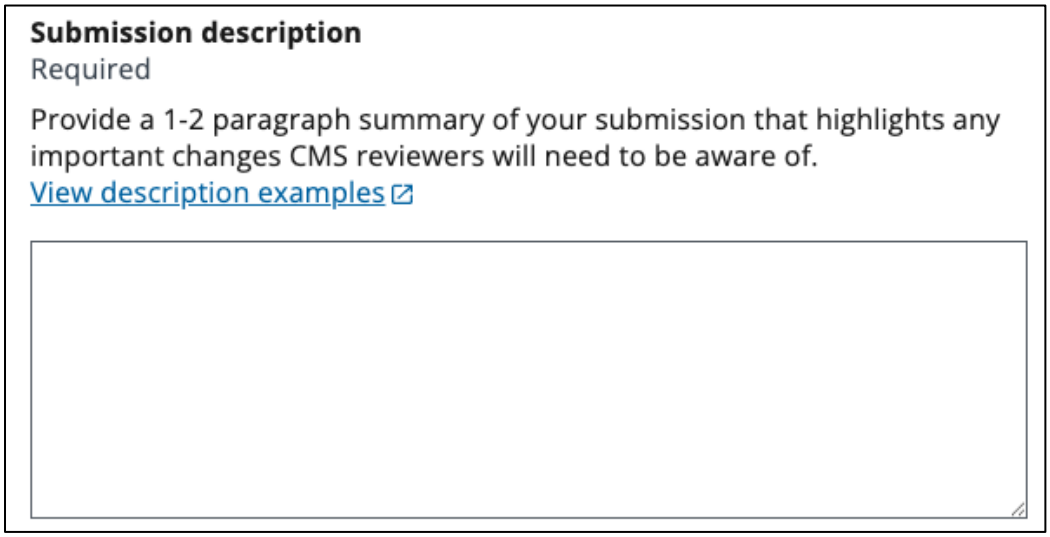


Figure 12: Submission Description Text Box

Two examples are provided below:

- **Example 1**: This [CONTRACT NAME] amendment revises calendar year (CY) YYYY capitation rates, adds new language concerning capitation payments related to a program no longer authorized by law, and changes the requirement that the MCO pay or deny clean paper claims within thirty (30), rather than twenty-one (21) calendar days of receipt.
- **Example 2**: [CONTRACT NAME] Amendment 8 adds SUPPORT Act DUR provisions effective MM/DD/YYYY; reinvestment account language to comply with State Rev. Stat §12-345; and a high-cost drug pool risk corridor. This amendment also modifies the capitation rates for rating period effective mm/dd/yyyy through xx/xx/xxxx. The capitation rate determination process; administrative expense rate calculation time frames; the CY YY Quality Performance Program measures; and general reporting requirements to remove duplicates.

3.2.2 Contract details

This is the portion of the form where you will enter the information related to the contract which is being submitted, including uploading the contract and supporting documentation.

For your awareness, you will be able to add a rate certification to your submission (if applicable) on the Rate details page. The Contract details page is intended to collect information related to your contract submission.

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- CMS accepts one model contract action per submission. This means that a submission can include more than one plan contract, but each plan contract should be effectuating the same modifications and generally will have the same effective dates.
- Contract actions with varying effective dates, different populations, covered benefits, or entity types should not be submitted in one submission.
- Multiple amendments with separate signature pages or different contract periods must be submitted separately.

If you need additional support on how to format your contract submissions in MC-Review, please reach out to your assigned DMCO Lead Analyst.

The remainder of this section outlines the fields which need to be completed in the contract details section of the form.

1. **Document upload**

   There are multiple fields provided which will allow you to upload required and optional documents to MC-Review as part of your submission. Unless otherwise specified, the following document types are accepted: pdf, csv, doc, docx, xls, xlsx.

   There are no file size limitations for the files you upload. Upon upload, all documents will go through a security scan for viruses or security vulnerabilities. The security scan process can take from several seconds to a minute, depending on the file size. If your files are failing security scan or you are experiencing upload errors, contact the help desk at MC_Review_HelpDesk@cms.hhs.gov. Details related to required and supporting documents can be found in Appendix B - Document definitions and requirements.

   The first document upload field is provided for you to upload the contract which you are submitting for CMS review. Refer to *Figure 13*.

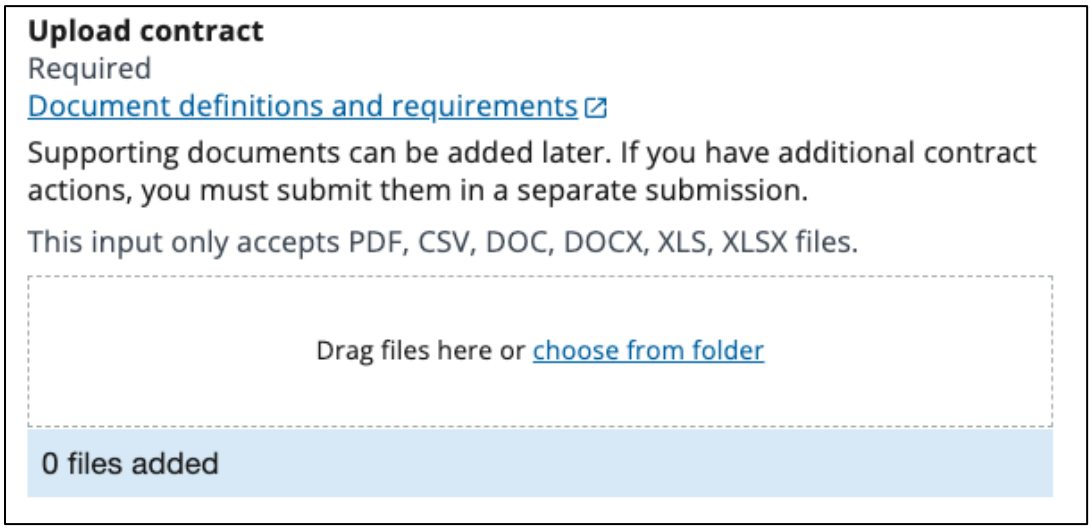


Figure 13: Upload Contract Documents Field

   There is also a field provided which you can use to upload contract-supporting documents. Refer to *Figure 14*.

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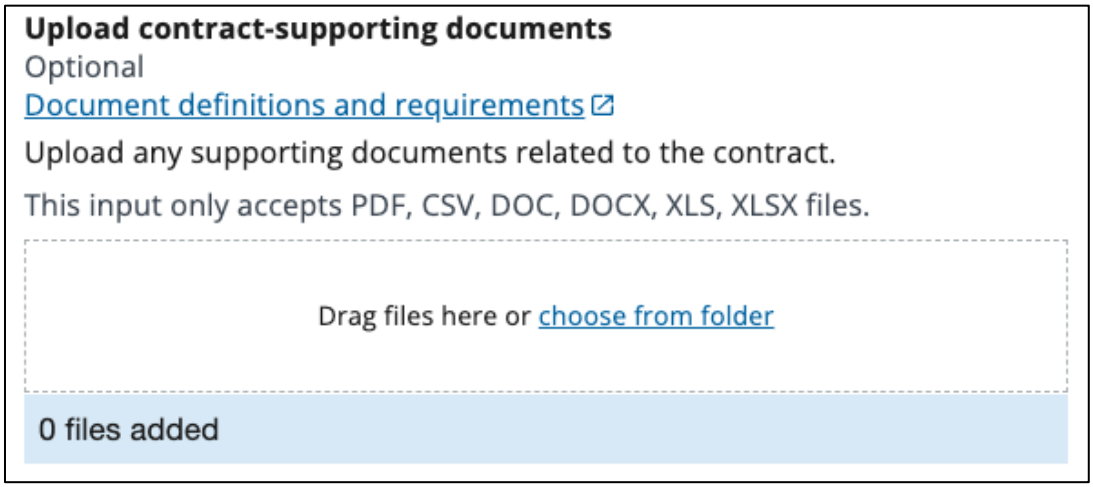


Figure 14: Upload Contract Supporting Documents Field

2. **Contract Status**

   You will need to identify the contract status as either fully executed or unexecuted by some or all parties. Refer to *Figure 15*.

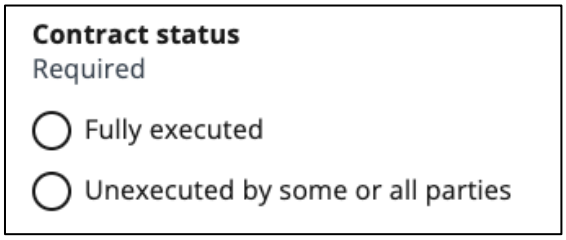


Figure 15: Contract Status Question

   You can refer to the section titled Unexecuted contracts for additional instructions related to submitting an unexecuted contract.

3. **Effective Dates**

   You will need to provide the Contract or Amendment effective dates. Both the start and end dates are required. Contract effective dates should reflect the full length of your initial base contract, which may span multiple years. Refer to *Figure 16.*

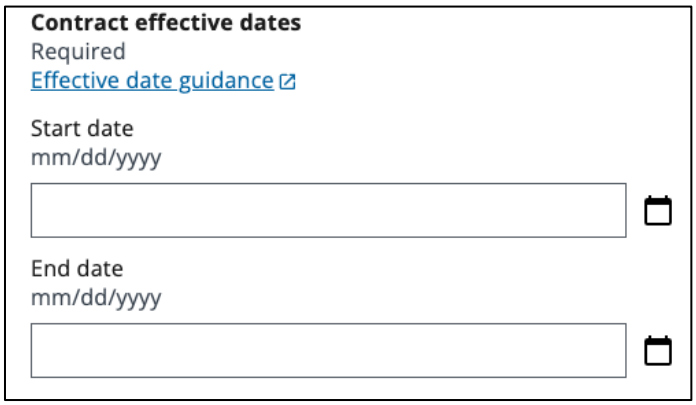


Figure 16: Contract Effective Dates

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Amendment effective dates should reflect the term of your contract amendment. Refer to *Figure 17*.

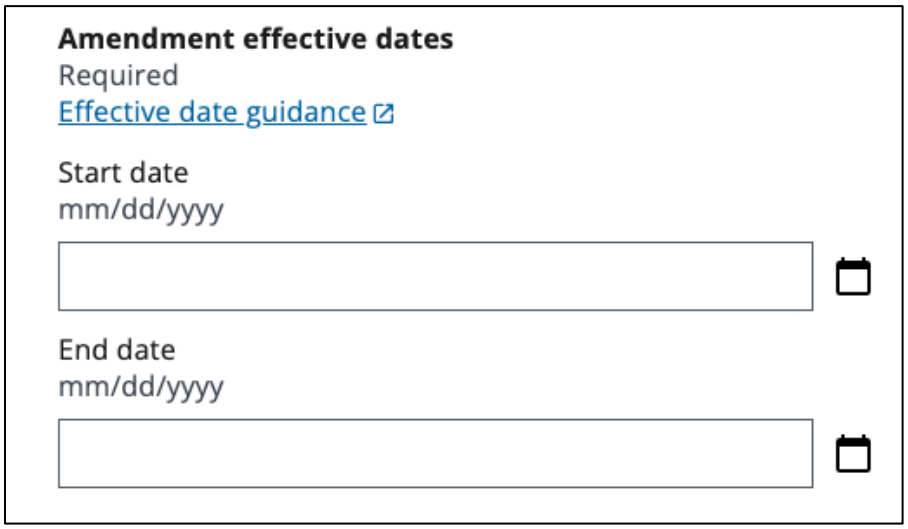


Figure 17: Amendment Effective Dates

4. **Managed Care entities**

   You will need to indicate all of the managed care entity type(s) operating under the contract. Refer to *Figure 18*.

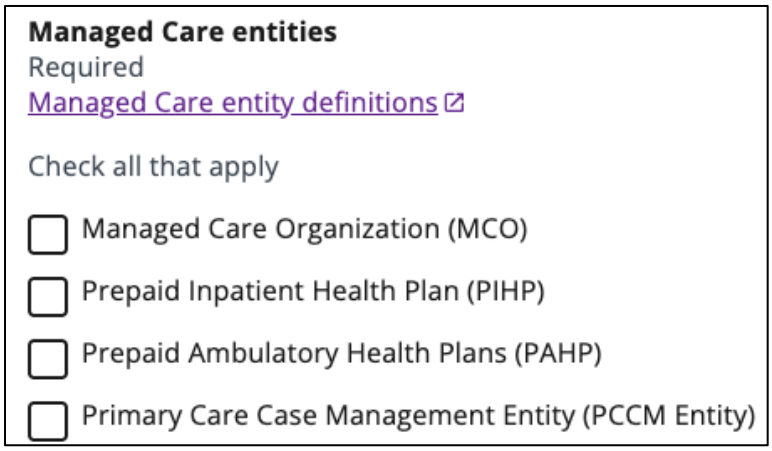


Figure 18: Managed Care Entities

5. **Active federal operating authority**

   You will need to indicate all of the active federal operating authorities which apply to the contract. Refer to *Figure 19*.

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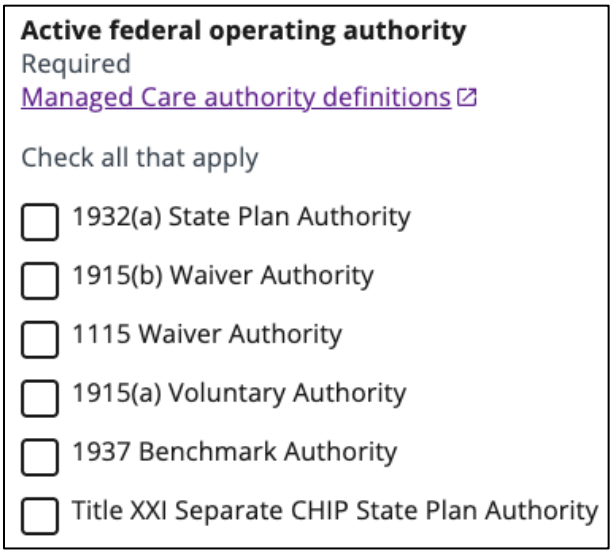


Figure 19: Active Federal Operating Authorities

6. **Is this contract associated with a Dual-Eligible Special Needs Plan (D-SNP) that covers Medicaid benefits?**

   When one or more of the following authorities are selected, then this additional question will be displayed and a response will be required. Refer to *Figure 20*.

   - 1932(a) State Plan Authority
   - 1915(b) Waiver Authority
   - 1115 Waiver Authority
   - 1915(a) Voluntary Authority

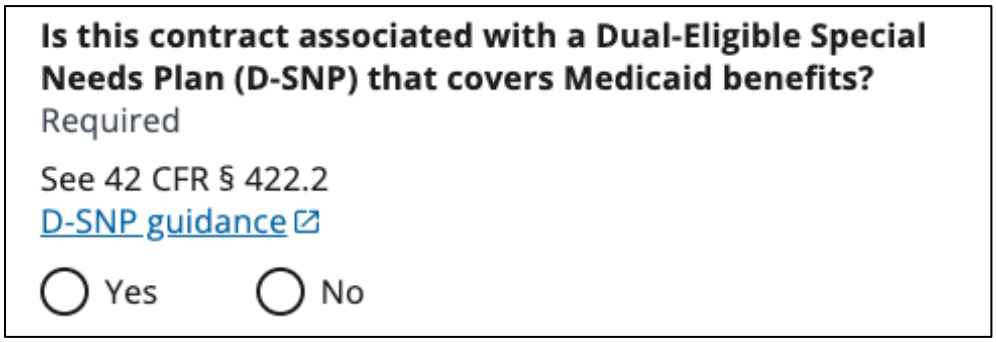


Figure 20: Is Dual-Eligible Special Needs Plan (D-SNP) Question

   Choose 'Yes' if either of the following applies:

   - This contract includes both Medicaid managed care and D-SNP requirements.
   - This contract is with a D-SNP that covers Medicaid benefits directly. This may include Coordination-Only (CO) D-SNPs, where applicable.
   - This contract fulfills a regulatory requirement to offer a Medicaid managed care plan that aligns with a Fully Integrated Dual Eligible Special Needs Plan (FIDE-SNP) or a Highly Integrated Dual Eligible Special Needs Plan (HIDE-SNP). See 42 CFR § 422 for additional details.

7. **Provision Information**

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Based upon the responses which have been provided to this point in the form, you will need to indicate whether or not the contract action includes provisions related to various regulations. Refer to *Figure 21*.

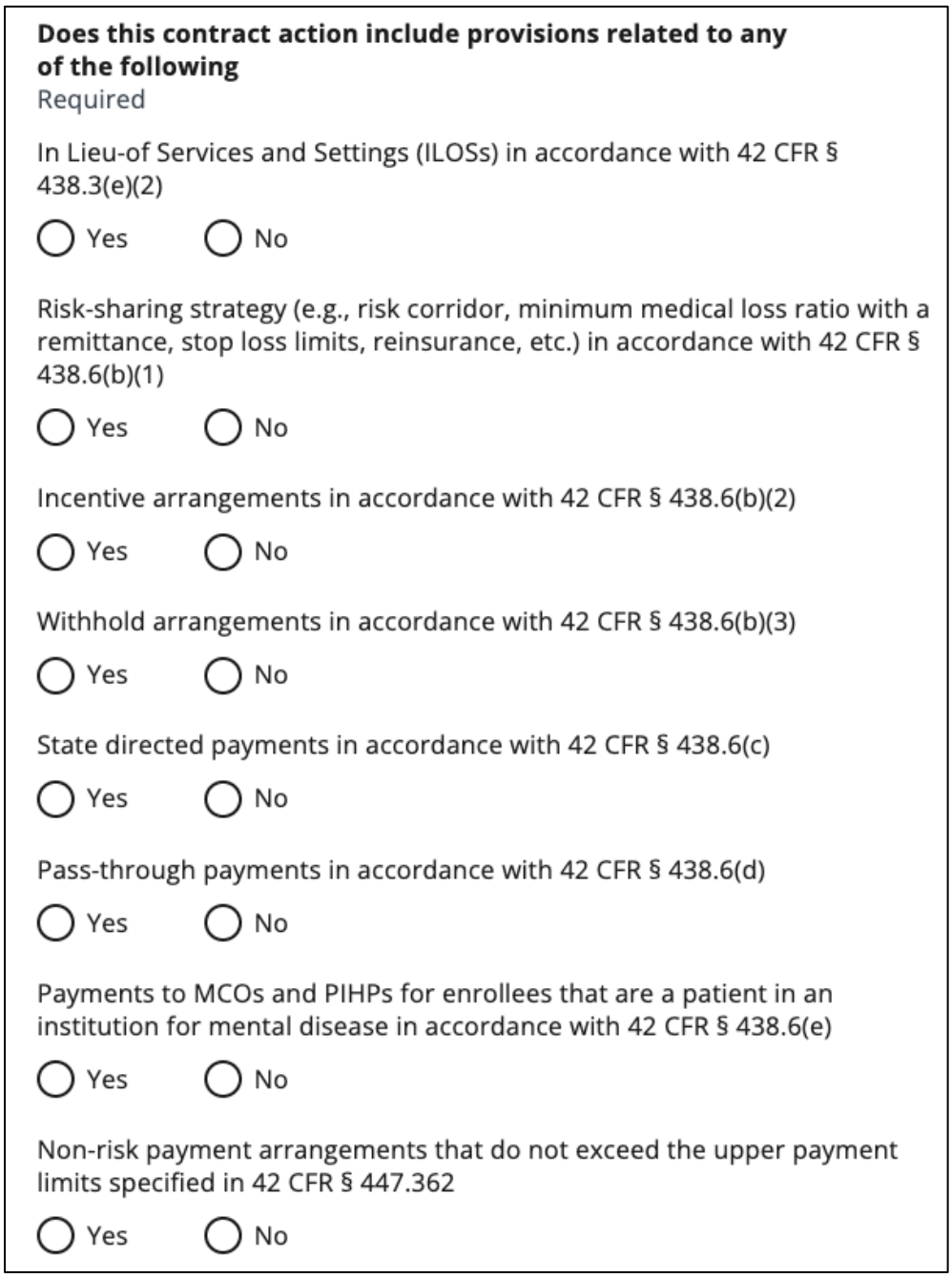


Figure 21: Contract Provision Selections

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3.2.3 Rate Details

Similar to the contract details page, the rate details page captures the rate certification and supporting rate documentation which CMS will need to conduct their review, as well as some basic information about the submission.

You have the opportunity to link a rate certification to multiple contract submissions. This is common if you have a rate certification that is associated with more than one contract. You will first be prompted to indicate if this contract submission is related to a rate certification which has been previously submitted as part of another submission. Refer to *Figure 22*.



Figure 22: Rate Certification Selection

3.2.3.1 No, this rate certification was not included with any other submissions

If you are trying to submit a new or amended rate certification which you have not submitted previously, then you will need to select, “No, this rate certification was not included with any other submissions.”

Once that selection has been made, additional fields will be displayed which will need to be completed to proceed. The remainder of this section outlines the fields which need to be completed in the Rate details screen, when a new or amended rate certification is being submitted.

Details related to required and supporting documents can be found in Appendix B - Document definitions and requirements.

1. **Upload rate certification document**

   This field allows you to upload only one rate certification document, and the file type must be PDF, DOC, or DOCX format. Refer to *Figure 23*.

CMS Proprietary

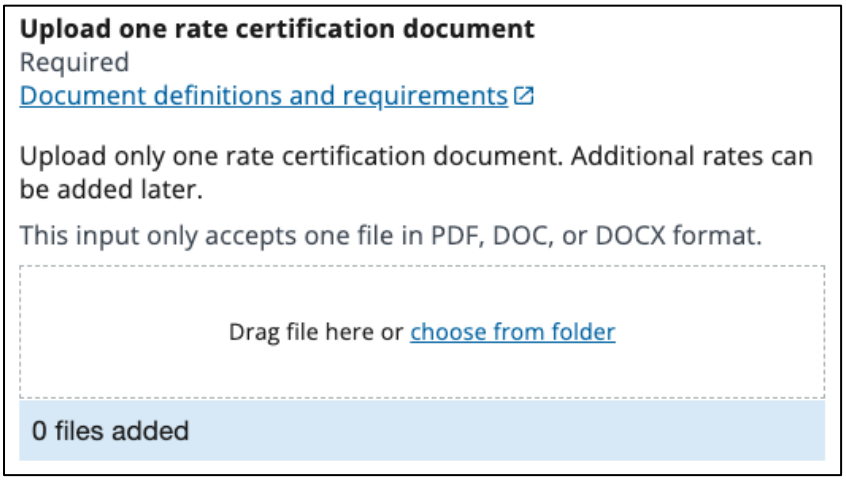


Figure 23: Upload Rate Certification Field

This field allows you to upload only one rate certification document, and the file type must be PDF, DOC, or DOCX format.

If you try to upload an additional document in the rate certification field, the subsequent upload will automatically replace the previously uploaded file. For an initial submission, please ensure that the file which is uploaded in this field is the rate certification document. If you are making changes to a prior submission, refer to Adding or replacing documents for information related to replacing a previously uploaded document in the rate certification field.

2. **Upload supporting documents**

   This field can be used to upload additional documents associated with the rate certification, including rate exhibits or other supporting documentation. Refer to *Figure 24*.

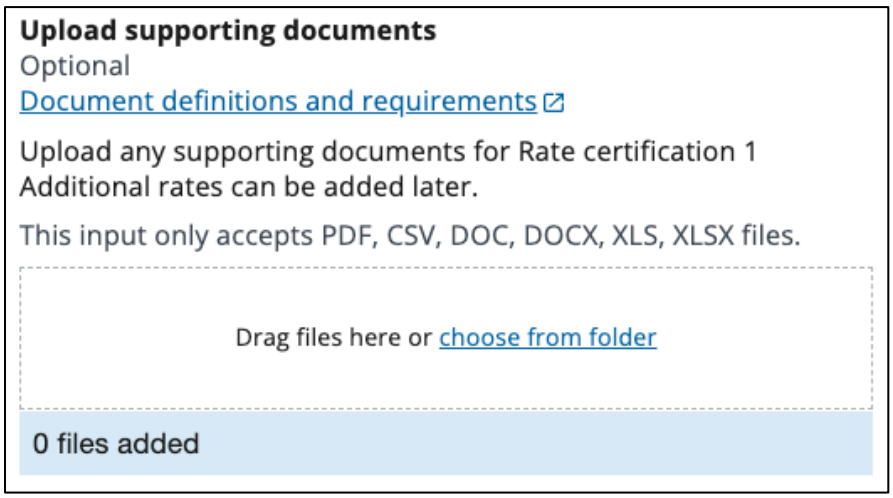


Figure 24: Upload Rate Supporting Documents Field

3. **Rates included in the certification**

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Similar to the functionality on the Contract details page, you need to select the programs or rate certification names which are applicable to your rate certification(s) submissions from a pre-set list on the “Rate details” page. Refer to *Figure 25*.

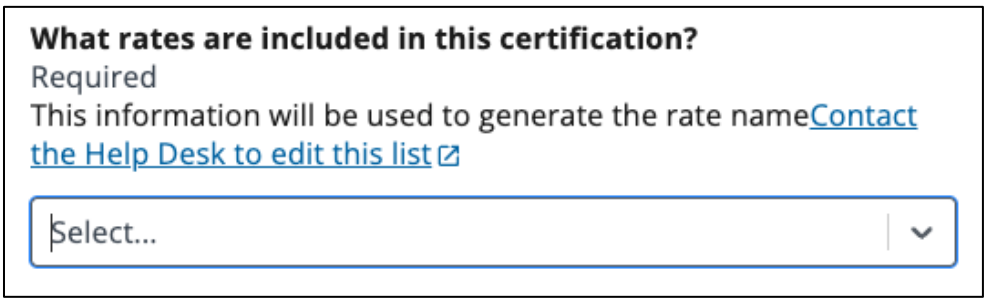


Figure 25: Rates Included in Certification Selection

If you do not see the correct state programs in this list, contact the help desk at MC_Review_HelpDesk@cms.hhs.gov with the name of the state program and the action to be taken (i.e. to add the program, remove the program, or edit the name of an existing program). Please obtain concurrence from all state users of CMS systems, reports and tools (for example, MCPAR, enrollment report, NAAAR etc.) before requesting a change as an approved change request will be implemented in all managed care systems and tools. State programs will not appear in the pre-set list if their corresponding submission types are out of scope (see section, What types of submissions and documents can be submitted in MC-Review).

4. **Medicaid populations included in the certification**

When a response of “Yes” has been provided to the question, “Is this contract associated with a Dual-Eligible Special Needs Plan (D-SNP) that covers Medicaid benefits?” on the contract details page, then the question, “Which Medicaid populations are included in this rate certification?” is populated on the rate details page and must be answered. Refer to *Figure 26*.

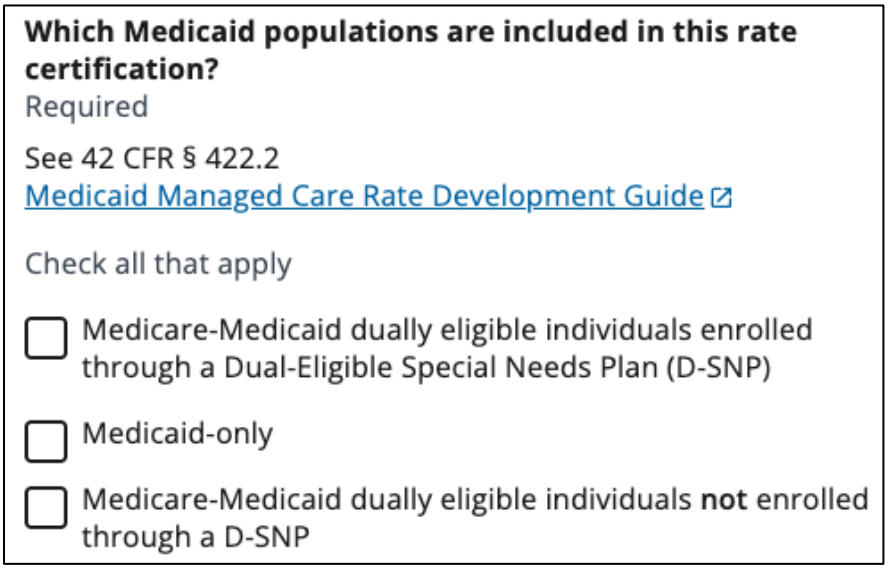


Figure 26: D-SNP Medicaid Populations Selections

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5. **Rate certification type**

   You must indicate whether the rate certification is a new rate certification or an amendment to a prior rate certification. Refer to *Figure 27*.

   - **New rate certification**: This should be selected for all rate certifications for initial base contracts and rate certifications for annual rate updates. If you have not previously submitted (whether via the portal or email) rates for the 12-month rating period on your certification, it is considered new.
   - **Amendment to prior rate certification**: This should be selected for any rate certifications that are making changes to capitation rates in your current 12-month rating period.

     If a contract amendment (which must be submitted in a separate MC-Review submission ID) is not needed then a revised version of a rate certification can be added to the same MC-Review submission but must be added as an independent amendment to a prior rate certification. It should not be added as an additional file in the original rate submission, as doing so would result in the initial rate certification file being overwritten with the new submission. Refer to Adding or replacing documents for information related to replacing a previously uploaded document in the rate certification field. If you need assistance with this process, reach out to your DMCO Lead Analyst.

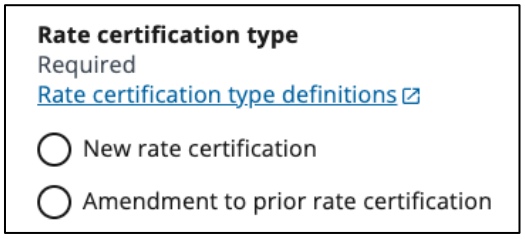


Figure 27: Rate Certification Type

   - When “New rate certification” is selected, then the user will need to enter both the start and end date of the rating period as well as the date certified. Refer to *Figure 28*.

CMS Proprietary

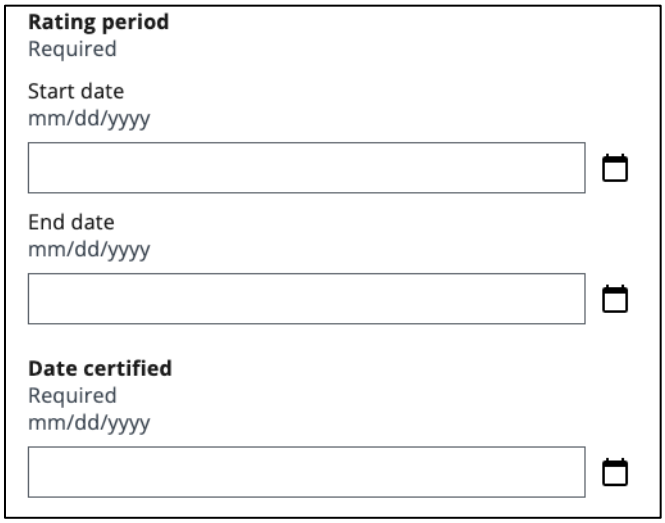


Figure 28: Rating Period Dates, New Rate Certification

- When Amendment to prior rate certification is selected, then the user will need to enter the start and end dates associated with the rating period of the original rate certification, the effective dates of the rate amendment (both start and end date) and the date certified for the rate amendment. Refer to *Figure 29*.

CMS Proprietary

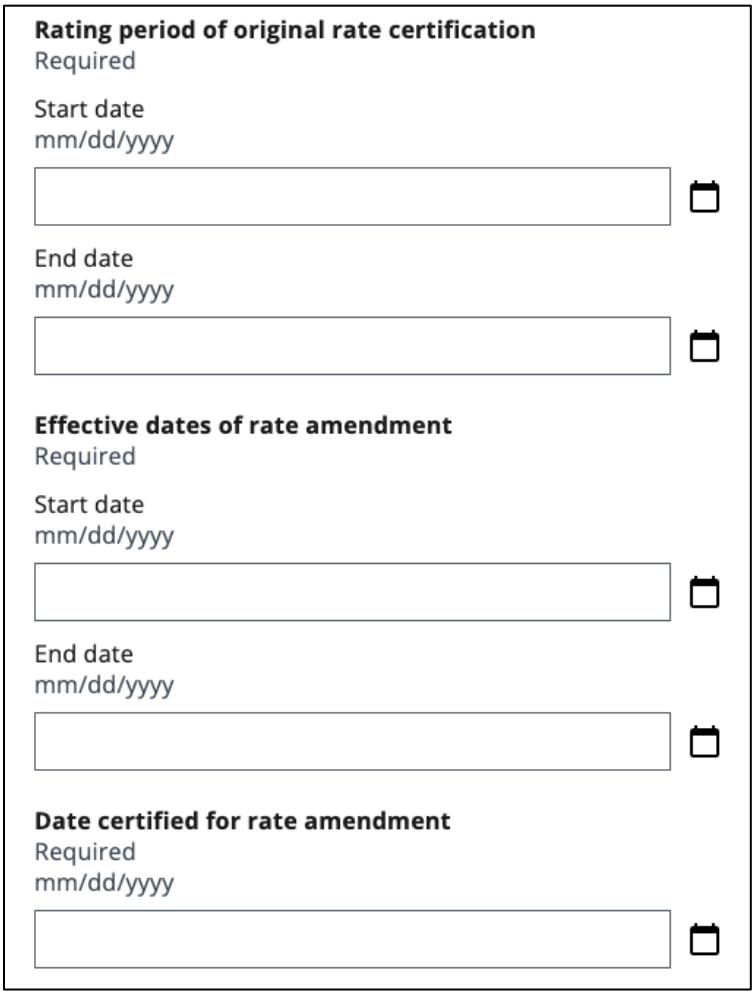


Figure 29: Rating Period Dates, Rate Amendment

6. **Capitation rates selection**

   You must indicate the manner in which the actuary certifies the capitation rates. The options are specific to each rate cell or to a rate range. Refer to *Figure 30*.

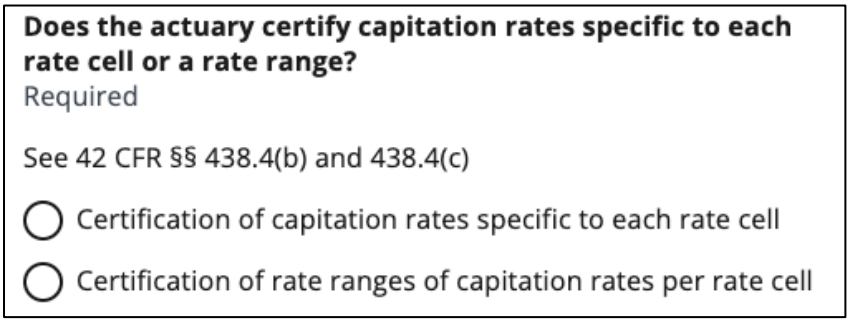


Figure 30: Capitation Rates Selection

7. **Certifying actuary and other actuary information**

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You must also provide additional information about the certifying actuary. The name, title/role, and email address for at least one actuary contact must be provided. Refer to *Figure 31*.

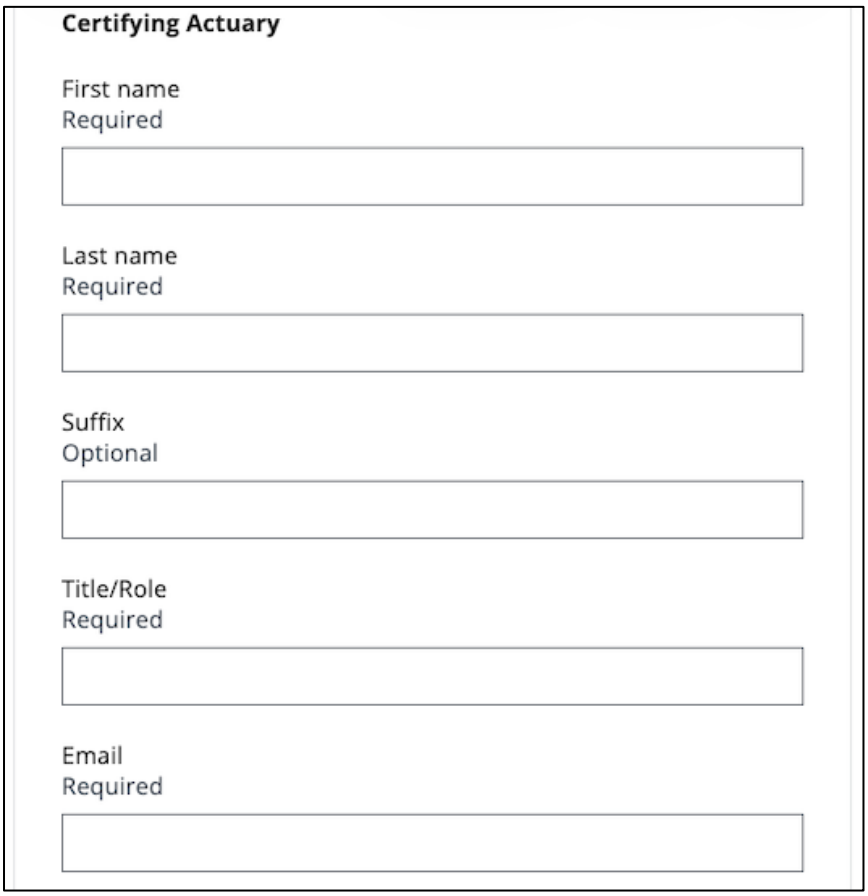


Figure 31: Certifying Actuary Information

Additionally, you will need to indicate the corresponding actuarial firm. Refer to *Figure 32*.

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Figure 32: Actuarial Firm

You also have the option to add as many additional certifying actuaries as you would like by clicking the “Add a certifying actuary” button. Refer to *Figure 33*.



Figure 33: Add Actuary Button

You will also need to indicate the actuaries’ communication preference. Refer to *Figure 34*.

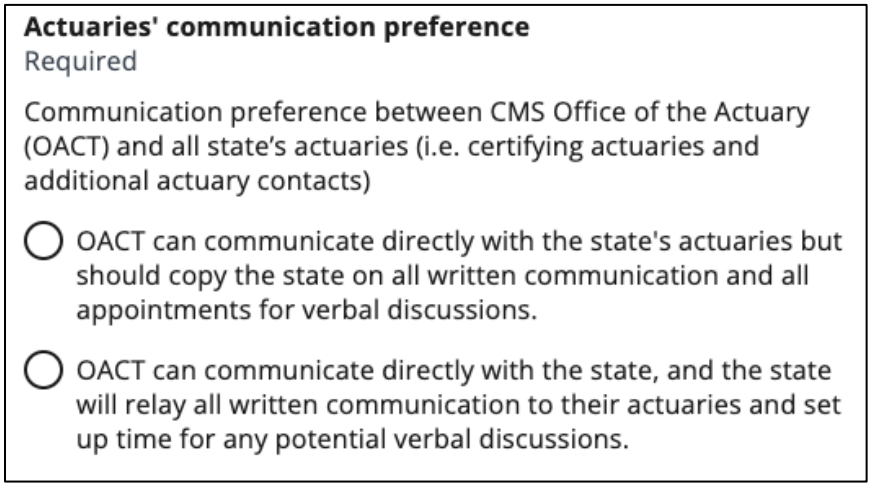


Figure 34: Actuary Communication Preference

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8. **If needed, you can use the "Add another rate certification" button to add as many rate certifications as necessary.**

   To add additional rate certifications, click the "Add another rate certification" button. Refer to *Figure 35*.

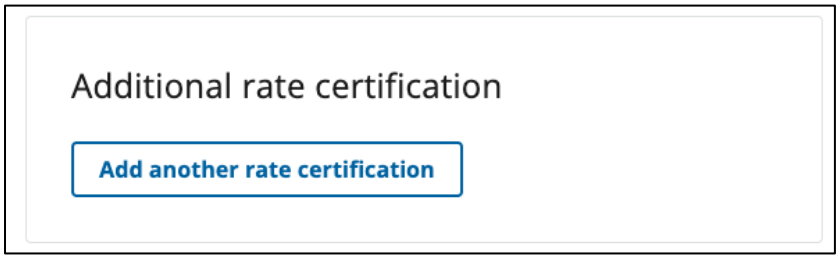


Figure 35: Add Another Rate Certification Button

3.2.3.2 Yes, this rate certification is part of another submission

If you are preparing a "contract and rate submission" and the rate certification pertaining to your contract has already been submitted to CMS in a separate submission, you must **not** re-upload the rate certification. Instead, you should indicate the rate name assigned to the previously submitted rate certification, if applicable.

You should only respond "Yes" if the identical rate certification was previously submitted and needs to be associated with the subsequent contract submission.

You should NOT respond "Yes" to create an association between rate certifications that are not identical. For example, if a rate certification is being replaced or amended, the answer to the prompt, "Was this rate certification included with another submission?" is "No" due to the new submission not being identical.

To do this, go to the Rate Details page, and on the first form field "**Was this rate certification included with another submission?**" and select "**Yes, this rate certification is part of another submission.**" Refer to *Figure 36*.

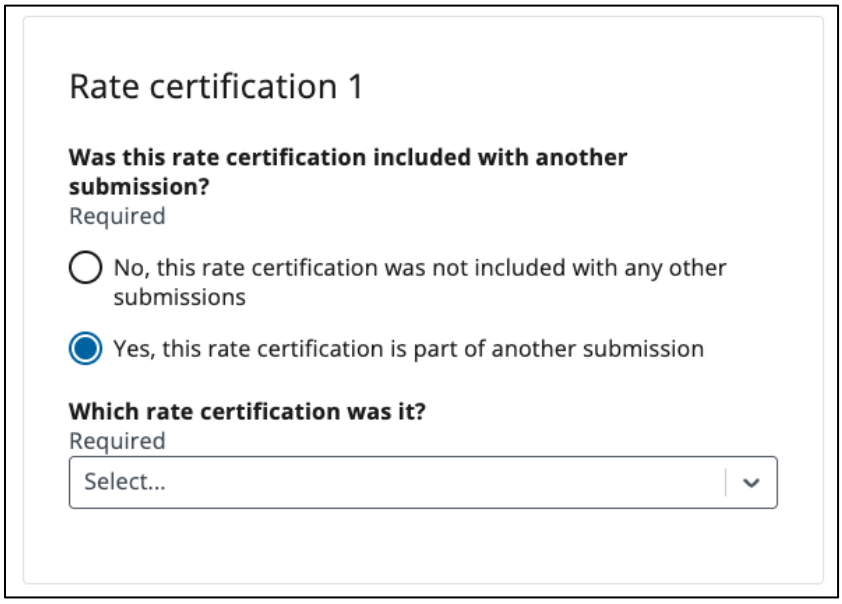


Figure 36: Rate Certification Selection, with Yes Selected

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You must indicate "**Which rate certification was it?**" from a dropdown list of rate names submitted through MC-Review. Refer to *Figure 37*.

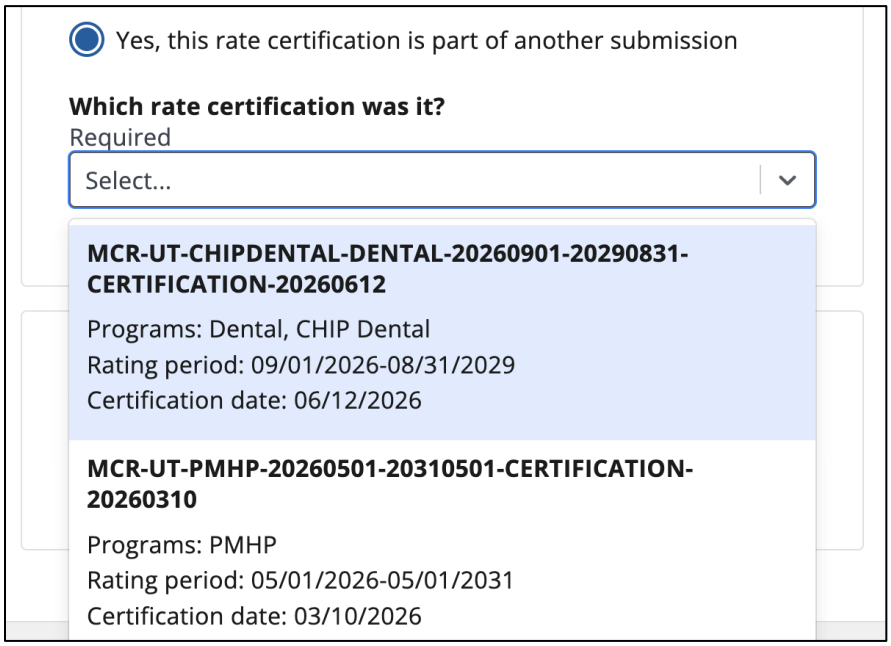


Figure 37: Rate Certification Dropdown Menu

The rate details for the selected rate name will pre-populate with the previously entered information and documents you provided to CMS.

Note: If the prior rate certification was submitted via email and not through MC-Review then it will not appear in this dropdown menu. In this instance, you should contact your DMCO Lead Analyst to discuss next steps.

3.2.4 Contacts

You need to enter at least one state contact on the contacts portion of the form. CMS will use the contact or contacts provided on this form for future communication on the submission. You should include any program or contract subject matter experts (SMEs) that will be able to answer any specific questions about the contracts under review. Note that only the staff that are listed as contacts in a submission will receive automated notifications about the status of the review. All state staff can log-in to their dashboards to view the submission, but only those listed on the contacts portion of the form will receive e-mail notifications. There is no limit to the number of contacts that you can provide. Refer to *Figure 38*.

CMS Proprietary

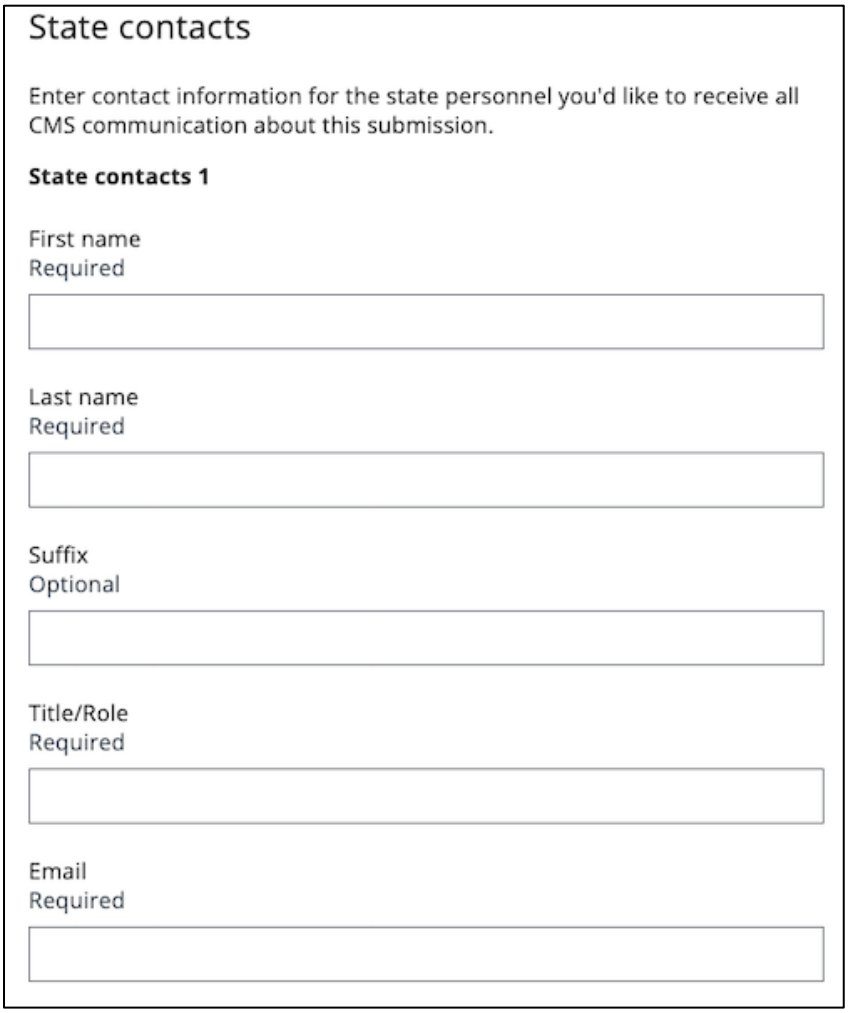


Figure 38: State Contact Entry Fields

3.3 Saving a draft submission

You do not need to complete the entire submission form at one time. You can start a submission, save it as a draft, and revisit it later. (Draft submissions cannot be viewed by CMS).

In order to save a submission to return to it later, you must at a minimum complete the first page of the submission form: the “Submission type” page.

Once you complete the “Submission type” page, you can save your submission as a draft from any other page of the submission form by selecting “Save as draft” on the bottom left of the screen. Refer to *Figure 39*.



Figure 39: Save as Draft Link

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If you exit the application without saving, your submission will be saved automatically and will be available as a draft on your state dashboard. Drafts cannot be deleted at this time. Refer to *Figure 40*.

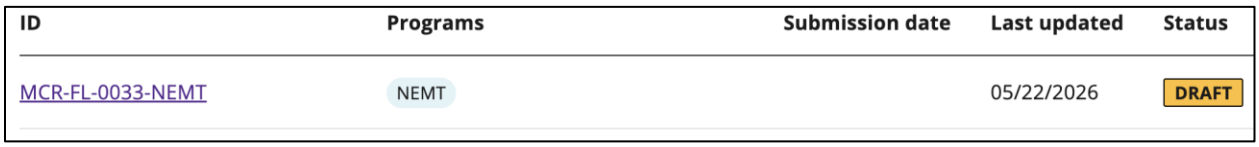


Figure 40: Submission Dashboard Showing a Submission in Draft Status

At this time, each page of the submission form must be filled out sequentially. This means you will be required to fill out information in the first sections of the form to progress to subsequent sections. However, states may go back to previous sections for editing while in draft mode at any time.

3.4 Collaborating on or sharing a draft submission

If you would like to collaborate with other State staff on completing the submission form, all collaborators must have accounts in MC-Review. Once a user has an account in your state, they will be able to view, modify, or submit submissions in MC-Review.

While it is possible for multiple users to update the same submission concurrently, it is best practice for users to avoid making edits to the same page of the form at the same time.

3.5 Submitting to CMS in MC-Review

After completing all required sections of the submission form, you have an opportunity to review the entire submission prior to submitting on the “Review and submit” page. Refer to *Figure 41*.

CMS Proprietary

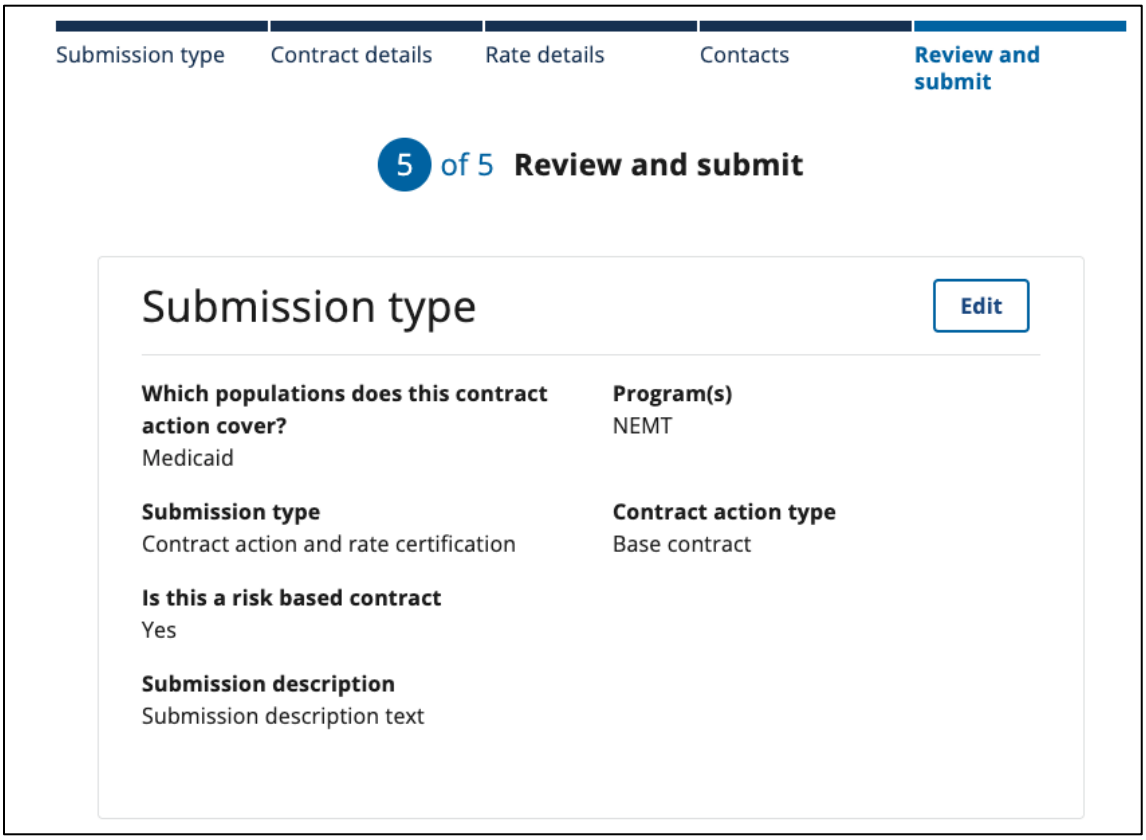


Figure 41: Review and Submit Page

Here you can revisit previous sections of the form and edit. Once you have verified that all information has been entered correctly, you will select “Submit” at the bottom of the page. Refer to *Figure 42*.

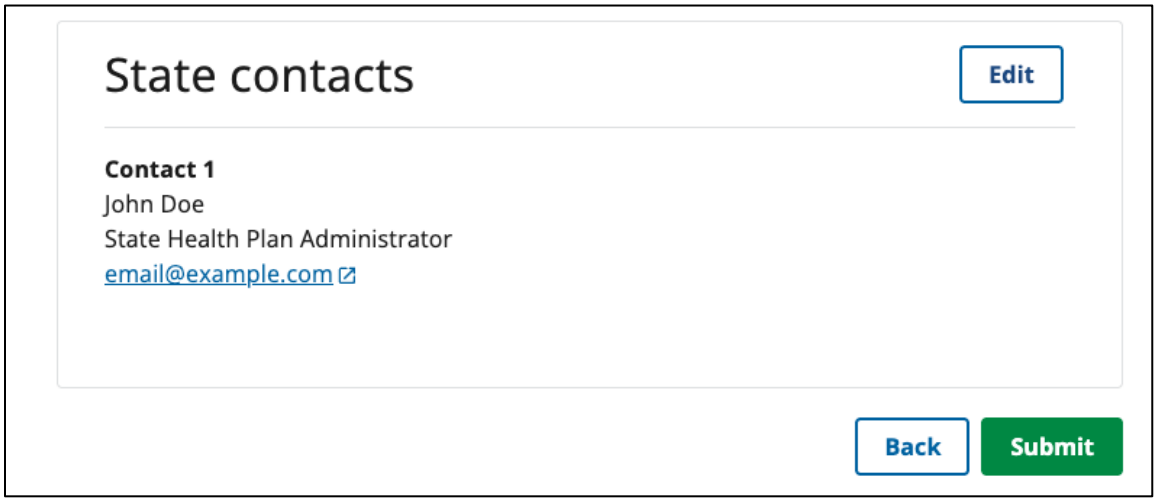
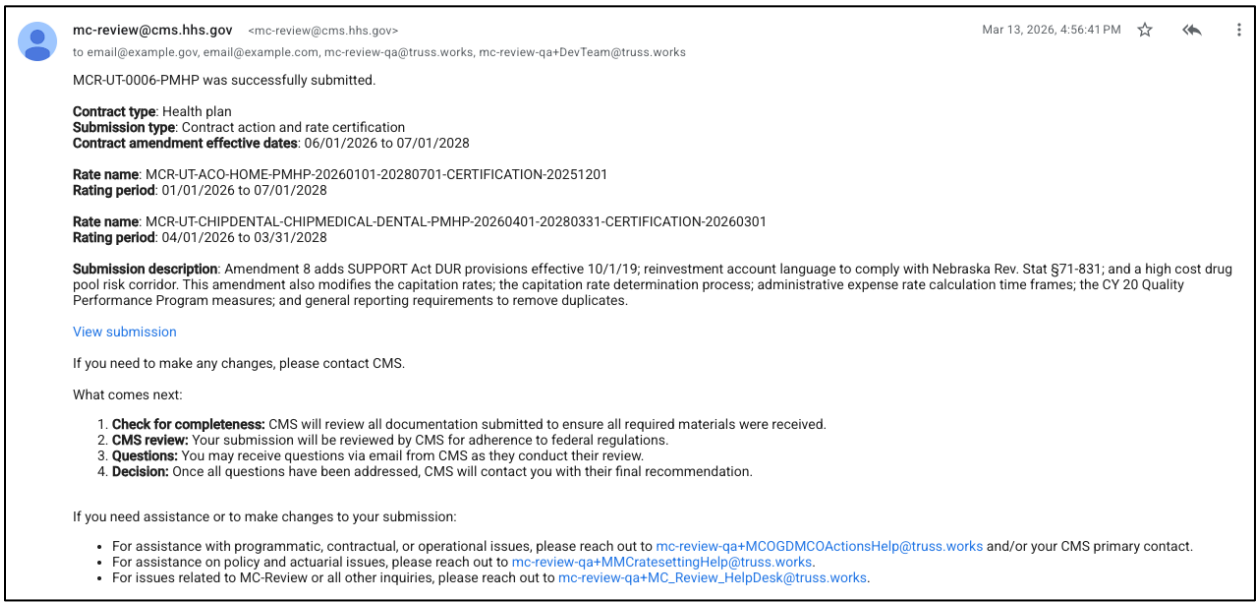


Figure 42: Submit Button

All state contacts listed on the submission will receive a confirmation email that the submission was sent.

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The confirmation email will contain a direct link to the submission and basic details about the submission, including the **submission ID** and the **rate name** for any rate packages, which CMS will use to reference your submission. If you are logged into MC-Review, then you can view the submission ID by clicking the direct link or by revisiting the submission from your dashboard. Refer to *Figure 43*.



mc-review@cms.hhs.gov <mc-review@cms.hhs.gov> Mar 13, 2026, 4:56:41 PM

to email@example.gov, email@example.com, mc-review-qa@truss.works, mc-review-qa+DevTeam@truss.works

MCR-UT-0006-PMHP was successfully submitted.

Contract type: Health plan
Submission type: Contract action and rate certification
Contract amendment effective dates: 06/01/2026 to 07/01/2028

Rate name: MCR-UT-ACO-HOME-PMHP-20260101-20280701-CERTIFICATION-20251201
Rating period: 01/01/2026 to 07/01/2028

Rate name: MCR-UT-CHIPDENTAL-CHIPMEDICAL-DENTAL-PMHP-20260401-20280331-CERTIFICATION-20260301
Rating period: 04/01/2026 to 03/31/2028

Submission description: Amendment 8 adds SUPPORT Act DUR provisions effective 10/1/19; reinvestment account language to comply with Nebraska Rev. Stat §71-831; and a high cost drug pool risk corridor. This amendment also modifies the capitation rates; the capitation rate determination process; administrative expense rate calculation time frames; the CY 20 Quality Performance Program measures; and general reporting requirements to remove duplicates.

View submission

If you need to make any changes, please contact CMS.

What comes next:

1. **Check for completeness:** CMS will review all documentation submitted to ensure all required materials were received.
2. **CMS review:** Your submission will be reviewed by CMS for adherence to federal regulations.
3. **Questions:** You may receive questions via email from CMS as they conduct their review.
4. **Decision:** Once all questions have been addressed, CMS will contact you with their final recommendation.

If you need assistance or to make changes to your submission:

- For assistance with programmatic, contractual, or operational issues, please reach out to mc-review-qa+MCOGDMCOActionsHelp@truss.works and/or your CMS primary contact.
- For assistance on policy and actuarial issues, please reach out to mc-review-qa+MMCratesettingHelp@truss.works.
- For issues related to MC-Review or all other inquiries, please reach out to mc-review-qa+MC_Review_HelpDesk@truss.works.

Figure 43: Successful Submission Email

Upon submitting to CMS, submissions become locked for editing. To make changes to the submission, you can contact CMS (via your assigned DMCO Lead Analyst and/or MCGDMCOActions@cms.hhs.gov) and request they unlock the submission.

3.6 Incomplete submissions and unexecuted contracts

3.6.1 Incomplete submissions

Effective July 1, 2025, CMS does not begin review of managed care plan contracts until minimum documentation standards are met. The components of a complete managed care plan contract submission, and CMS minimum documentation standards are outlined in the November 2023 CMCS Informational Bulletin.

Additional resources for contract and rate submissions, including the *Medicaid Managed Care Rate Development Guide*, and the *State Guide to CMS for Medicaid Managed Care Contract Review and Approval*, are posted on Medicaid.gov.

CMS strongly encourages States to submit contract actions consistent with all applicable documentation standards before the effective date of the managed care plan contract to facilitate timely and efficient review by CMS.

CMS recognizes that there are instances where a state may need to submit an incomplete submission to CMS. For example, a State may need to submit draft contract language, and rate certification documentation prior to the start of the rating period to meet risk mitigation arrangement requirements under 42 CFR § 438.6(b)(1).

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In these cases, states are still required to complete all required sections of the submission form to submit any contract and rate action to CMS.

For incomplete submissions, states will need to ask CMS to unlock the submission in order to upload the final executed contracts finalized rate certifications, and any additional supporting documentation.

3.6.2 Unexecuted contracts

CMS **will** accept submissions of managed care contract actions that are not executed through MC-Review in situations where states are planning to implement one or more risk mitigation strategy(ies). This documentation must include contract and rate certification documents that incorporate the risk mitigation strategy into the contract between the state and the managed care plan. Refer to Section 1. "Managed Care Rates" in the Medicaid Managed Care Rate Development Guide for more details. Refer to *Figure 44*.

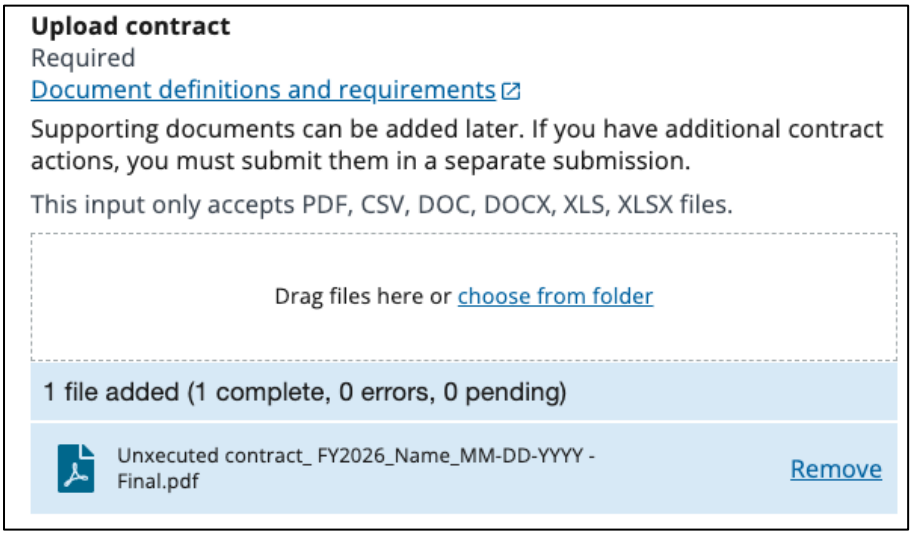


Figure 44: Upload Contract Documents Field with an Unexecuted Contract

When submitting an unexecuted contract, you should select “Unexecuted by some or all parties” for the “Contract Status” in the Contract Details section of the submission form. Refer to *Figure 45*.

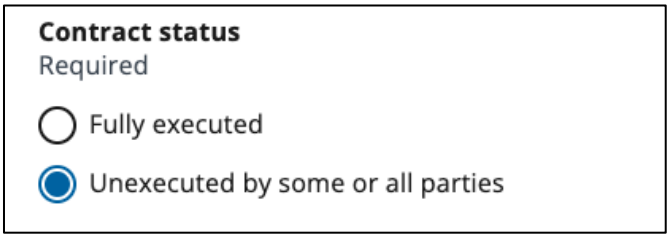


Figure 45: Contract Status Questions with Unexecuted Response

If you have submitted an unexecuted contract, **you will be required to upload an executed contract before the submission can be reviewed and approved by CMS**.

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When you are ready to submit the executed contract, you must request that CMS unlock your submission for editing. Once it is unlocked, **do not** remove the unexecuted contract; just add the executed copy to the submission, under the "Contract" section. Refer to *Figure 46*.

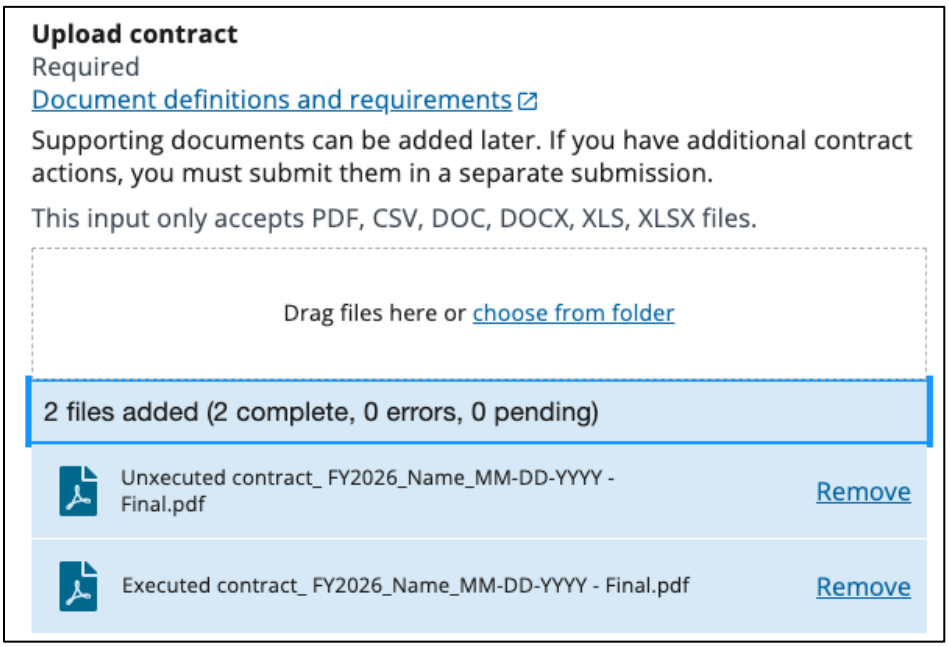


Figure 46: Upload Contract Documents Field with Both an Executed and Unexecuted Contract

You must also update the "Contract Status" to be "fully executed". (See section below on "Making Edits to a Submission" for more information). Refer to *Figure 47*.

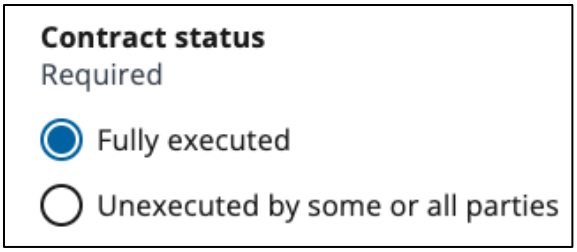


Figure 47: Contract Status Question with Executed Response

4. Post-submission activities

4.1 Submission review and approval

Once DMCO receives your contract submission, they may reach out to you via e-mail to ask informal questions about your submission (for example: to ask about the status of missing documentation). CMS will reference the submission ID or rate name when they communicate to you about your submission.

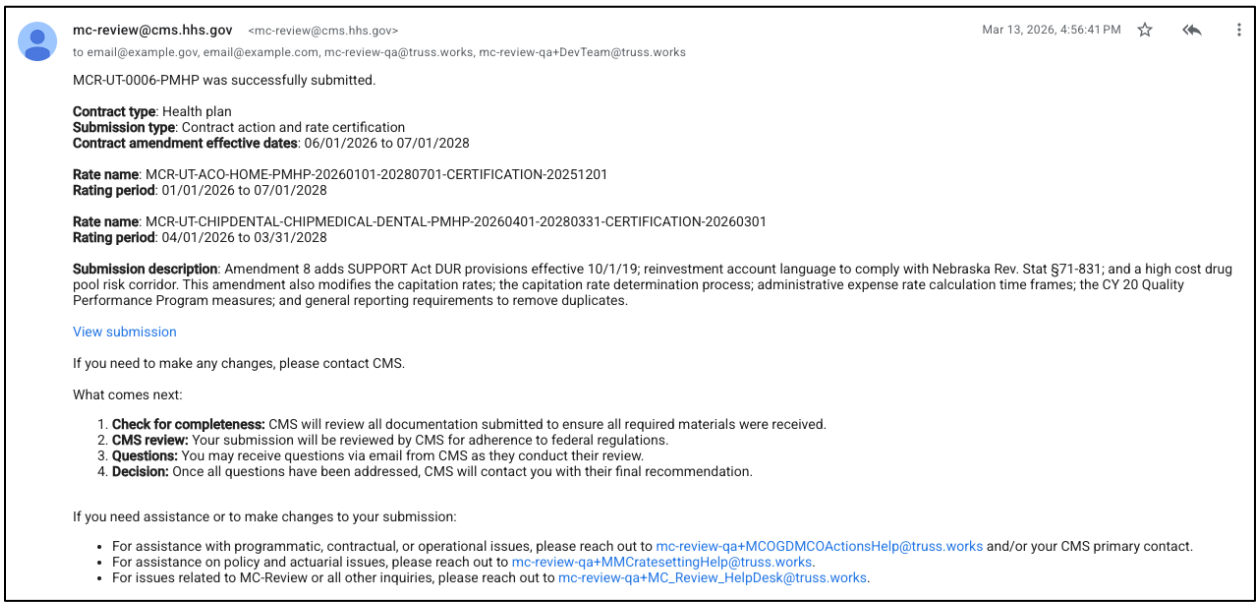
Formal communications as a result of DMCO's contract review will be shared through the MC-Review portal. CMS will continue to communicate approval decisions via email.

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These can be found on your submission and within system notification emails related to your submission.

4.1.1 State submission confirmation email

As CMS conducts their review, they may require additional documentation be submitted as part of your submission. If so, you will receive an email notification that your submission has been unlocked and a change has been requested. This will require you to log in and edit the submission (see section, “Making changes to a submission that has been sent to CMS” for details). Refer to *Figure 48*.



mc-review@cms.hhs.gov <mc-review@cms.hhs.gov> Mar 13, 2026, 4:56:41 PM

to email@example.gov, email@example.com, mc-review-qa@truss.works, mc-review-qa+DevTeam@truss.works

MCR-UT-0006-PMHP was successfully submitted.

Contract type: Health plan
Submission type: Contract action and rate certification
Contract amendment effective dates: 06/01/2026 to 07/01/2028

Rate name: MCR-UT-ACO-HOME-PMHP-20260101-20280701-CERTIFICATION-20251201
Rating period: 01/01/2026 to 07/01/2028

Rate name: MCR-UT-CHIPDENTAL-CHIPMEDICAL-DENTAL-PMHP-20260401-20280331-CERTIFICATION-20260301
Rating period: 04/01/2026 to 03/31/2028

Submission description: Amendment 8 adds SUPPORT Act DUR provisions effective 10/1/19; reinvestment account language to comply with Nebraska Rev. Stat §71-831; and a high cost drug pool risk corridor. This amendment also modifies the capitation rates; the capitation rate determination process; administrative expense rate calculation time frames; the CY 20 Quality Performance Program measures; and general reporting requirements to remove duplicates.

View submission

If you need to make any changes, please contact CMS.

What comes next:

1. **Check for completeness:** CMS will review all documentation submitted to ensure all required materials were received.
2. **CMS review:** Your submission will be reviewed by CMS for adherence to federal regulations.
3. **Questions:** You may receive questions via email from CMS as they conduct their review.
4. **Decision:** Once all questions have been addressed, CMS will contact you with their final recommendation.

If you need assistance or to make changes to your submission:

- For assistance with programmatic, contractual, or operational issues, please reach out to mc-review-qa+MCOGDMCOActionsHelp@truss.works and/or your CMS primary contact.
- For assistance on policy and actuarial issues, please reach out to mc-review-qa+MMCratesettingHelp@truss.works.
- For issues related to MC-Review or all other inquiries, please reach out to mc-review-qa+MC_Review_HelpDesk@truss.works.

Figure 48: Successful Submission Email

4.1.2 Questions about rate certifications

CMS will continue to send questions about rates via email at this time. We will notify you when this functionality becomes available in MC-Review.

4.2 Receiving, viewing, and responding to formal DMCO questions

DMCO analysts may require the state to answer questions about the submission as they conduct their review. The formal questions transmitted through the portal are typically related to the language included in the contract, and any supporting documents.

4.2.1 Notifications about DMCO questions

When DMCO sends a new round of questions, all state contacts who were included on the submission will receive an email notification. Click “Open the submission in MC-Review to answer questions” to view and download the questions. Refer to *Figure 49*.

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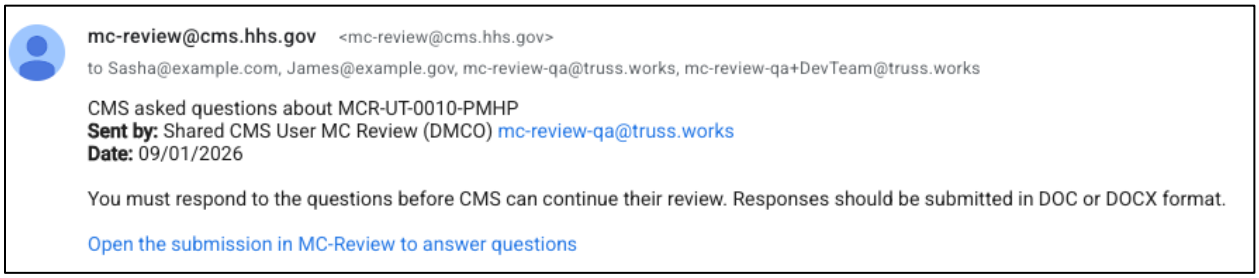


Figure 49: Questions Received Email

4.2.2 Viewing Q&A

There are two ways to view Q&A:

- **From automated notification emails**: Each notification email contains a link to view Q&A. You will be required to log in to MC-Review to view and download questions sent by CMS.
- **From the state dashboard**: Log in to MC-Review and select a submission from the dashboard. From the submission summary, click "Contract questions" or "Rate questions" in the sidebar to view the corresponding questions. Questions that need a response will be highlighted in the section, Outstanding questions. Refer to *Figure 50* and *Figure 51*.

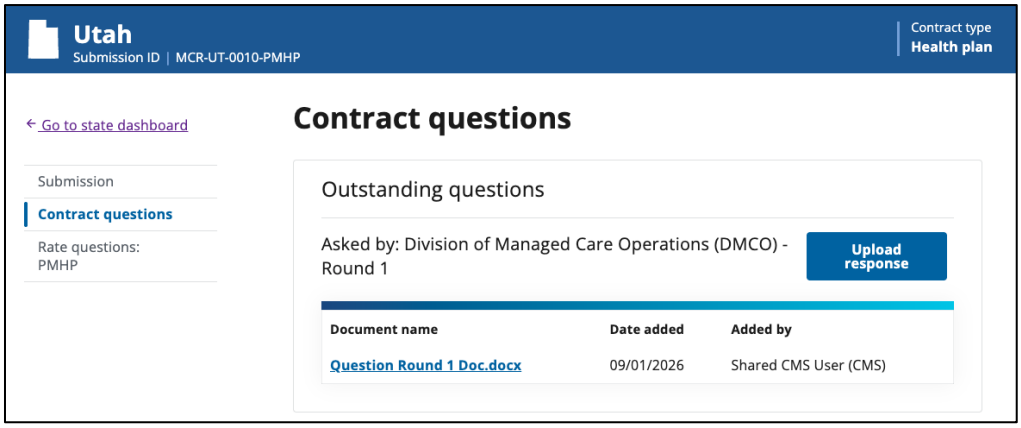


Figure 50: Contract Questions Page

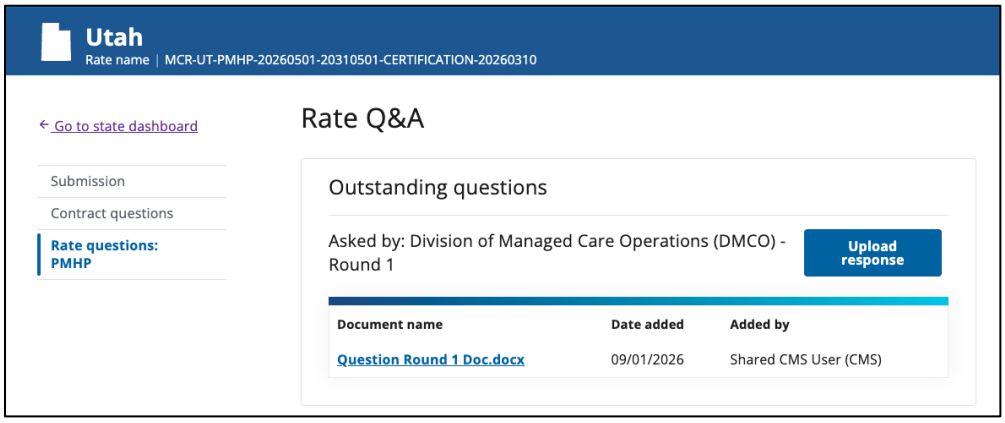


Figure 51: Rate Questions Page

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4.2.3 Responding to questions

To respond to a round of questions, you must upload a document that contains your responses. On the Contract or Rate questions page, select “Upload response”. This will take you to a form where you can upload your response document. Refer to *Figure 52*.

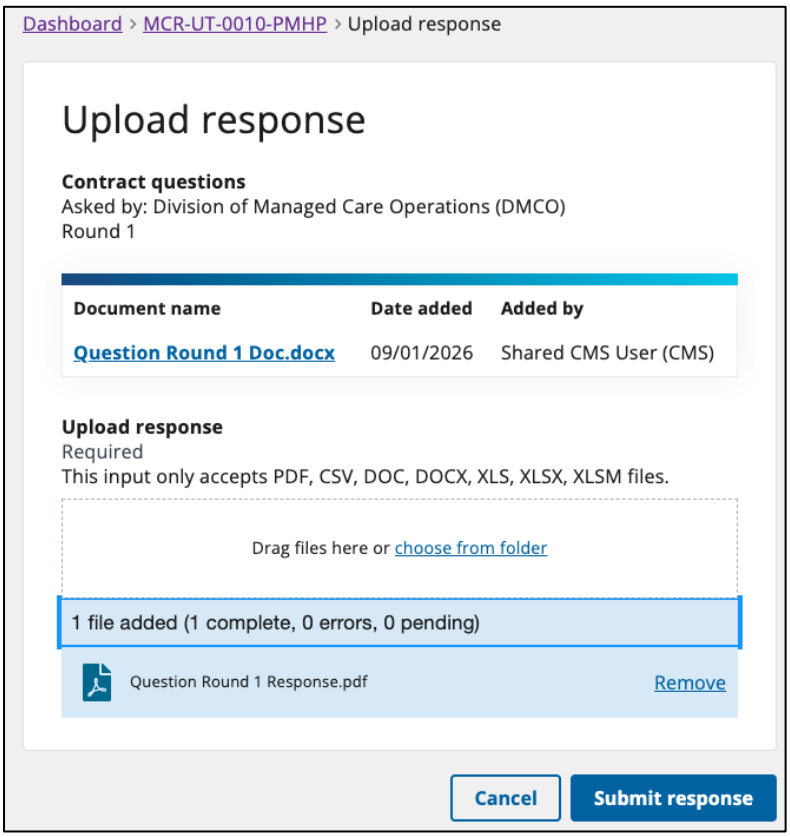


Figure 52: Upload Response Page

You can upload your responses as a PDF, CSV, DOC, DOCX, XLS, or XLSX file. There is no limit to the number of files you can upload. Once you have uploaded all files for the round, click “Submit response” to transmit your response to CMS.

You will receive a confirmation email alerting you that your response has been submitted. Click “View response” in the email to view your state’s response. You can also view the question rounds and responses by going to the Contract and Rate question pages, respectively. Refer to *Figure 53*.

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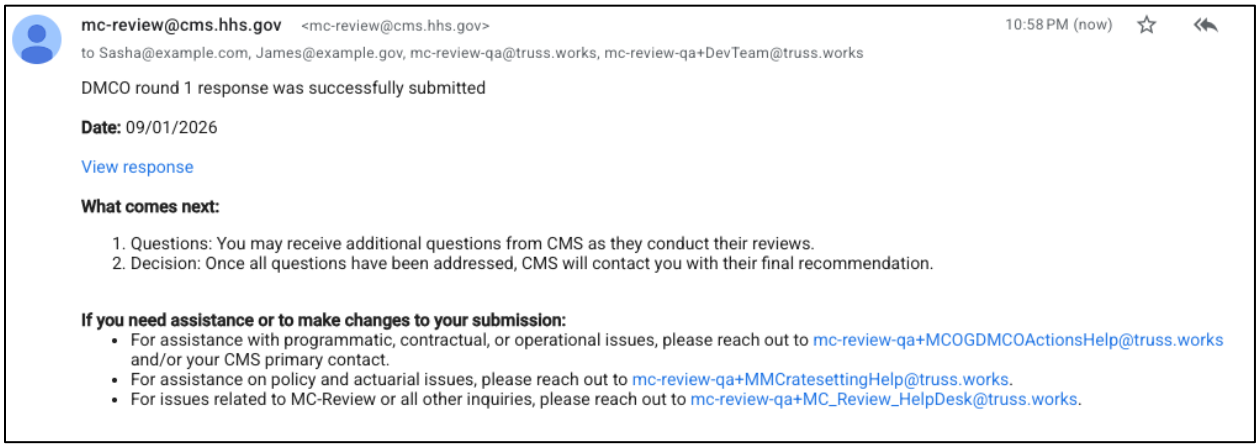


Figure 53: Response Successfully Submitted Email

4.3 Making changes to a submission that has been submitted to CMS

4.3.1 Editing a submission sent to CMS

Once a submission has been submitted to CMS, it is locked for editing. CMS will unlock a submission if they require you to make changes to your submission. If you need to make a change to a locked submission, you can also request an unlock from your DMCO Lead Analyst via email.

If CMS unlocks a submission, you will receive an email notifying you that the submission has been unlocked, with a description of the required changes and a direct link to go edit. Refer to *Figure 54*.



Figure 54: Unlock Notification Email

From your state dashboard, a submission with a status of “Unlocked” indicates the submission requires action by the state. Refer to *Figure 55*.

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ID	Contract type	Programs	Submission date	Last updated	Status
MCR-UT-0010-PMHP	Health plan	PMHP	03/16/2026	08/21/2026	UNLOCKED

Figure 55: Submission Dashboard Showing a Submission in Unlocked Status

Once your submission is unlocked, you can edit any section of your submission.

When you have finished editing your submission, you will need to submit your changes to CMS by navigating through the form to the “Review and Submit” section and selecting “Submit”. CMS will not be able to view any changes you make to a submission until you re-submit.

When you submit, you will be asked to summarize the changes you made to the submission. Refer to *Figure 56*.

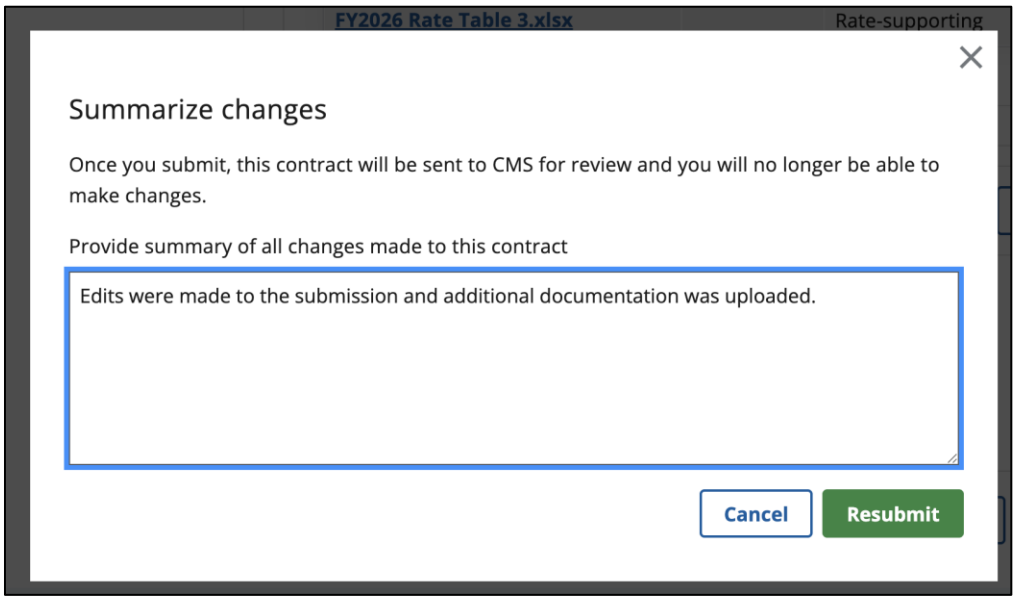


Figure 56: Unlock Summary Details

Once you submit your changes to CMS, the submission will be locked for editing.

4.3.2 Adding or replacing documents

If you are adding a document or replacing a previously submitted document on a section of the submission form, do not delete the prior version(s) unless directed to do so by CMS. Before deleting, consider whether your original submission date needs to be preserved and/or the document was a final unexecuted contract that CMS will need to have continued access to for comparison with the executed version.

If CMS concurs with deletion, you can do this by clicking “remove” next to the file and uploading the updated version of the file. Removed documents will still be viewable in the change history but will be archived from the most current version of the submission. Refer to *Figure 57*.

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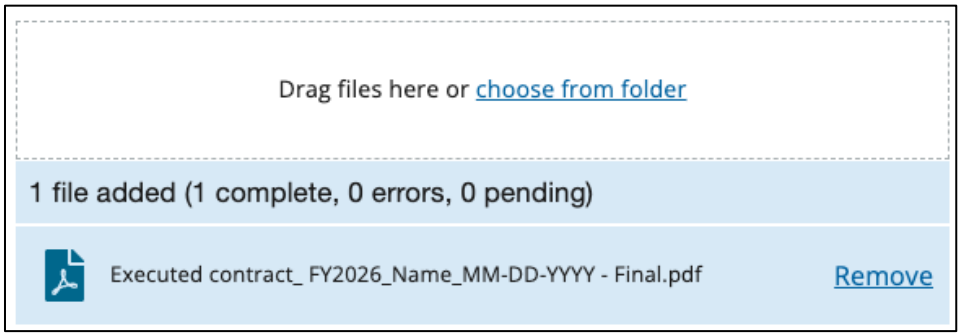


Figure 57: Remove Document Link

Note: If you are replacing a file or adding additional files, you may also need to update fields within the submission form to reflect the changes made. For example, if your rate certification needed to be revised and re-certified, you should also update the form fields on the Rate Details section with the updated information. Similarly, if your contract has been revised, you should revisit the form fields on the Contract Details page and update any previously entered information about your contract that may have changed.

The rate certification field only allows for one file to be uploaded. If you try to upload an additional rate certification file in this field, the current file will be replaced. If the intention is not to replace the file which was uploaded with the initial submission, then you should not make any changes to this field. Replacing or overwriting a previously submitted rate certification is not a preferred approach and should first be discussed with your CMS contacts.

The following approach should be used when you wish to either (1) Add a new rate certification to a previously submitted contract action or (2) Submit an amended version of a previously submitted rate certification:

- Follow the steps outlined in Editing a submission sent to CMS to request that CMS unlock the submission.
- Once the submission has been unlocked by CMS, navigate to the Submission and click the “Edit” button which is available in the “Rate Details” section of the form. Refer to *Figure 58*.

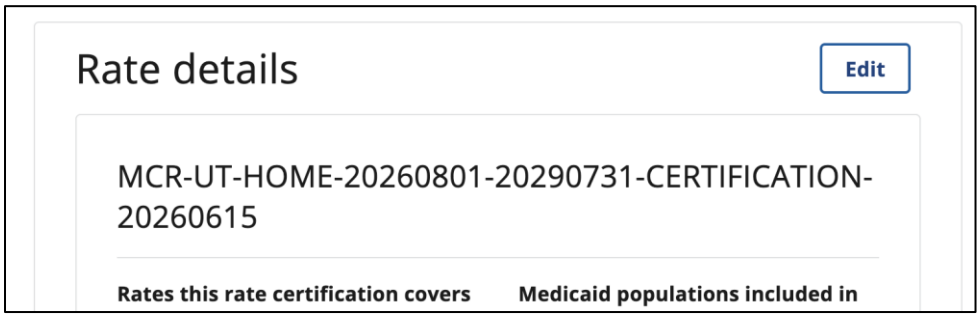


Figure 58: Edit Button in Rate Details Section

- Scroll to the bottom of the Rate Details page and click the Additional rate certification button. Refer to *Figure 59*.

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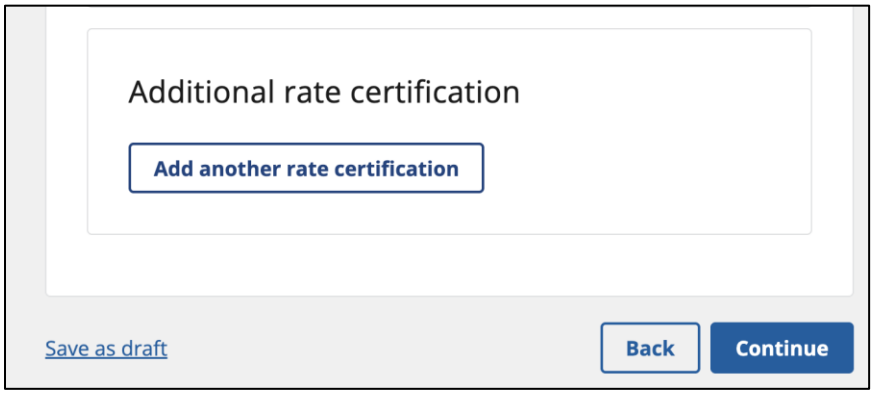


Figure 59: Add Another Rate Certification Button

- Follow the process which has been outlined in the Rate Details section of this document to enter the rate certification information.
- Once all rate certification information has been added, follow the steps outlined in Editing a submission sent to CMS to complete the resubmission to CMS.

4.3.3 Viewing the change history and previous versions of a submission

You can view the change history and any previous versions of your submission by navigating to submission and scrolling to the bottom of the page. Refer to *Figure 60*.

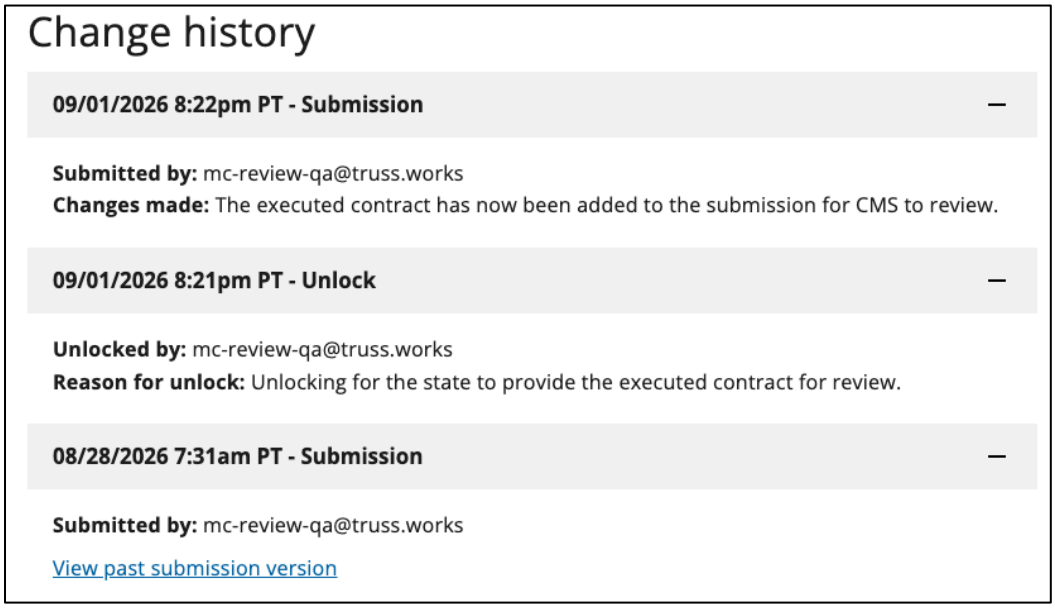


Figure 60: Change History

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4.4 Submission notifications

4.4.1 How to update state contact information and email settings

Anyone listed as a state contact on the submission can expect to receive communications about the submission. Currently, the state contact information is set per submission, not globally for all submissions. If you need to change the state contact information for a submission, you must request that CMS unlock the submission for editing. (See section, Making changes to a submission that has been sent to CMS for details.)

4.5 How to withdraw a submission

CMS has the ability to completely withdraw a contract or rate submission, if needed. If you need to withdraw a submission that has been submitted to CMS in error, notify your DMCO Lead Analyst directly via email with the submission ID and rate name (if applicable) and include the reason for the withdrawal. The withdraw process can only be initiated by CMS. Once CMS completes the withdrawal process, the submission will remain on your dashboard with a "Withdrawn" status.

4.6 How to delete a draft submission

There is not currently a way to delete a draft submission in MC-Review. However, all sections and form fields of a draft submission can be edited. If you have created a draft submission and it is no longer needed, you can always repurpose the draft you have started for a future submission. If you do repurpose a draft submission, make sure to review and update all applicable sections as appropriate.

CMS cannot view draft submissions.

4.7 How to print and save to PDF

If you need to print or save your completed submission to PDF, you can do so in your web browser settings. Navigate to your browser settings menu and select **Print**. If you would like to save the page as a PDF instead of printing, change the print destination to **Save as PDF**, then click **Save**. Refer to *Figure 61* and *Figure 62*.

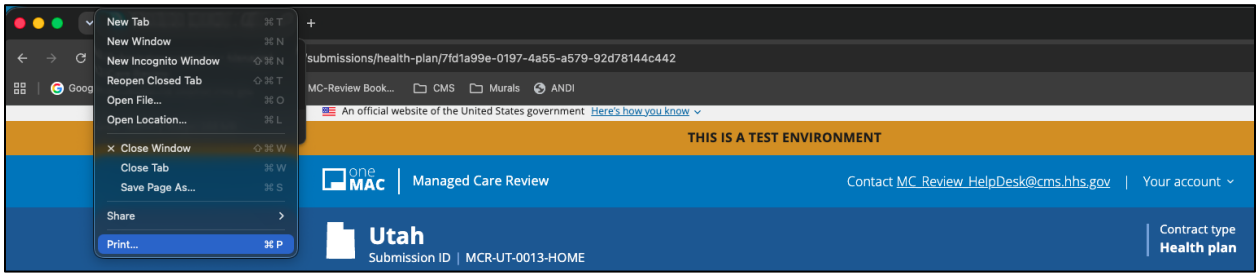


Figure 61: Print Option

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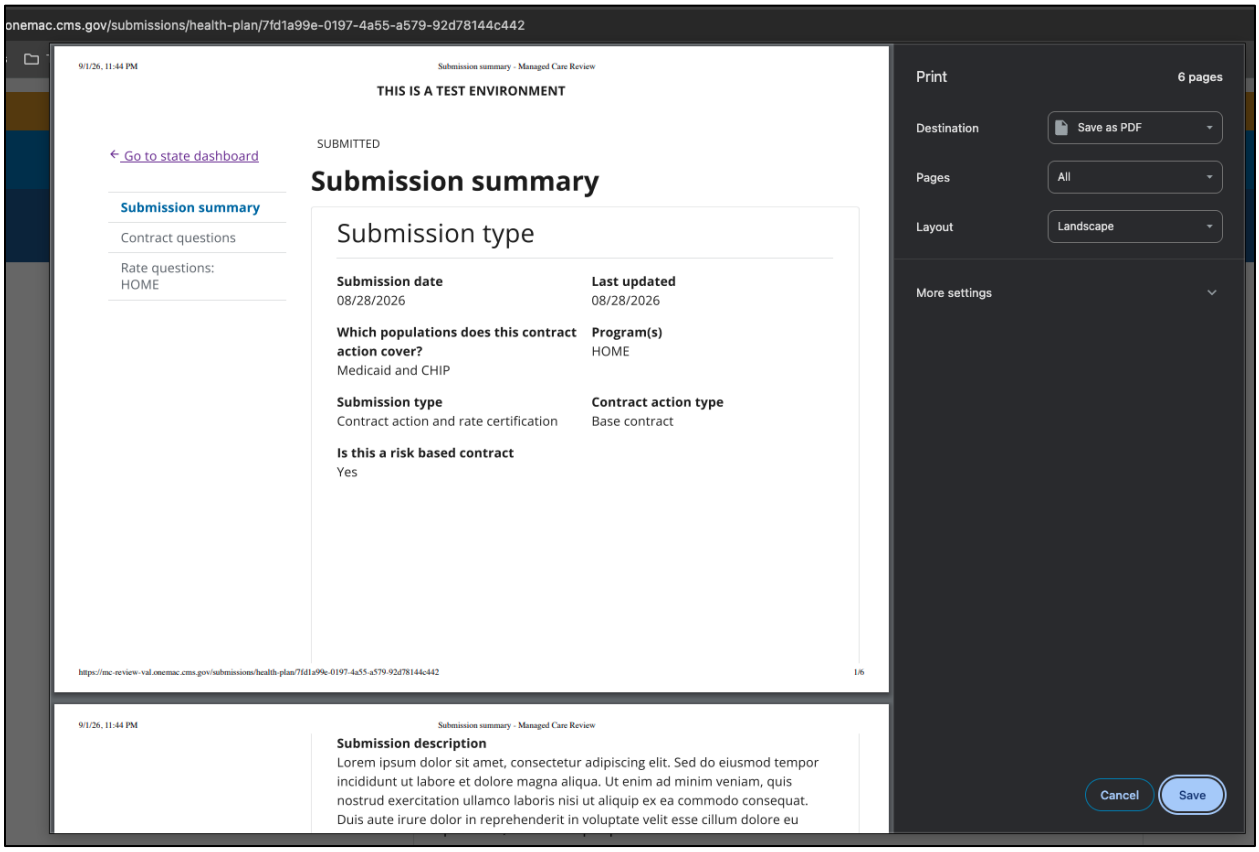


Figure 62: Print Preview of the Submission Summary Page

4.8 How to get help and give feedback

- If you have any questions or feedback, or if you experience any issues with the MC-Review portal, email MC_Review_HelpDesk@cms.hhs.gov
- For any questions specific to the expected contents of a completed submission, or any questions related to a contract review, contact your DMCO Lead Analyst and the MCGDMCOActions@cms.hhs.gov mailbox.
- For rate related questions, email MMCRateSetting@cms.hhs.gov
- For MLR or Risk Mitigation questions, email DMCPMLR@cms.hhs.gov

Appendix A: Revision History

Table 1 provides a revision history for this document.

Table 1: Revision History

Date	Version	Description
2024	1.0	Version currently available on the website
10/06/2026	2.0	Updated to reflect current processes and screenshots

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Appendix B: Document Definitions and Requirements

Table 2 provides an overview of the key documents as referenced in this user manual.

Table 2: Key Documents

Document Type	Definition	Required	Regulatory Reference	MC-Review Category
Base contract	The initial language agreed to by all parties.	For all "base contract" submissions.	Medicaid: § 438.3(a) CHIP: § 457.1201	Contract
Contract amendment	Amended language agreed to by all parties for a change to the base contract (or a previous amendment)	For all "amendment to base contract" submissions.	Medicaid: § 438.3(a) CHIP: § 457.1201	Contract
Signature pages	The base contract or amended contract, must be signed and dated by all parties. Signature pages can be incorporated in the base contract or amendment file, or can be attached separately.	For all submissions	Medicaid: § 438.3(a) CHIP:§ 457.1201	Contract
Rate certification	The actuarial certification of the rates or rate ranges, along with the report from the actuary describing the development of the rates or rate ranges.	For all "contract action and rate certification" submissions.	Medicaid: § 438.7	Rate certification

Table 3 provides an overview of the supporting documents as referenced in this user manual.

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Table 3: Supporting Documents

Document Type	Definition	Required	Regulatory Reference	MC-Review Category
Additional Contract Documents	All appendices, attachments, and any documents incorporated by reference into the contract. Please note: Adding a new appendix during the course of a contract period requires an executed "amendment to base contract" submission.	Required for all "base contract" and "amendment to base contract" submissions.	November 7, 2023 CMCS Informational Bulletin	Contract - supporting
Contract inclusive of prior amendments highlighting all current changes (Redline or Track Changes document)	CMS recommends that states submit a complete contract inclusive of prior amendments highlighting all current changes	Recommended	11.8.2019 CMCS Informational Bulletin	Contract - supporting
Readiness review results	The state's assessment of the ability and capacity of the managed care plan to satisfactorily perform operations/administration, service delivery, and financial management functions per 42 CFR 438.66(d)(4)(i) - (iii)	For all "contract action" submissions where a state implements 1) a new managed care program, 2) a new managed care plan not previously contracted with the state, or 3) the provision of covered benefits to new eligibility groups.	Medicaid: § 438.66(d)(2)(iii)	Contract - supporting

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Document Type	Definition	Required	Regulatory Reference	MC-Review Category
MH/SUD Parity Analysis	Mental Health Parity and Addiction Equity Act of 2008 (MHPAEA) is a federal law that generally prevents group health plans and health insurance issuers that provide mental health or substance use disorder (MH/SUD) benefits from imposing less favorable benefit limitations on those benefits than on medical/surgical benefits. This analysis supports the parity of those benefits.	For all "contract action" submissions where a state provides any services to MCO enrollees using a delivery system other than the MCO and 1) a change in benefits provided by the MCO, PIHP, PAHP or FFS is occurring or 2) the State is contracting with a new MCO(s).	Medicaid: § 438.3(n)(2), § 438.920 CHIP: § 457.496(f), § 457.1201(l)	Contract - supporting
Rate development index	The rate certification must include an index that identifies the page number or the section number for each item described within this guidance. In cases where not all sections of this guidance are relevant for a particular rate certification (i.e., a rate amendment that adds a new benefit for part of the year), inapplicable sections of the guidance must be included and marked as “Not Applicable” in the index.	For all "contract action and rate certification" submissions. All rate certifications must be accompanied by an index and this index should also follow the structure of the most recent Rate Development Guide from CMS.	§ 438.7(a), § 438.7(d) Section 1. Item 1.B.v. of the Medicaid Managed Care Rate Development Guide	Rate - supporting

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Document Type	Definition	Required	Regulatory Reference	MC-Review Category
Accelerated rate review -- rate development summary	In order to receive an accelerated rate review, states must submit a Rate Development Summary that includes all elements listed in the most recent Rate Development Guide from CMS.	For all "contract action and rate certification" submissions where states elect to use the accelerated rate review process.	§ 438.7(d) Appendix A of the Medicaid Managed Care Rate Development Guide	Rate - supporting
Rate appendix / exhibit	Supplementary material related to a rate certification. Appendices can be included within the rate certification itself or submitted as separate documents.	For all "contract action and rate certification" submissions. All documents attached to a rate certification must be submitted.	§ 438.7(a)	Rate - supporting
Other Rate Documentation	A document that relates to the rate certification, but is not described by the other available document types.	Optional	§ 438.7(a)	Rate - supporting
Actuarial justification	Document that explains how rates continue to be actuarially sound, despite contract modifications.	For all “contract action only” submissions which include modifications that could reasonably impact rates.	§ 438.4	Contract - supporting
Per cell rate change documentation	Documentation of the percentage change of the rate adjustment per rate cell in comparison to the most recently certified actuarially sound capitation rates.	For all “contract action only” submissions that increase or decrease the capitation rates per cell up to 1.5% during the rating period.	§ 438.7(c)(3)	Contract - supporting

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Document Type	Definition	Required	Regulatory Reference	MC-Review Category
Per cell rate range change documentation	Documentation of the percentage change of the rate adjustment per rate cell in comparison to the most recently contracted rates consistent with the certified actuarially sound rate ranges.	For all "contract action only" submissions that increase or decrease the capitation rates per cell within the certified rate range up to 1% during the rating period.	§ 438.4(c)(2)	Contract - supporting

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Appendix C: Glossary of Terms

Table 2 provides terms, abbreviations, and associated definitions for this document.

Table 4: Glossary of Terms

Term	Abbreviation	Definition
Children's Health Insurance Program	CHIP	CHIP is a program HHS administers that provides matching funds to states for health insurance to families with children. The program covers uninsured children in families that are modest, but too high to qualify for Medicaid.
Dual Eligible Special Needs Plan	D-SNP	Enroll individuals who are entitled to both Medicare (title XVIII) and medical assistance from a state plan under Medicaid (title XIX).
Managed Care Organizations	MCOs	Managed care entity that provides comprehensive benefit package Payment is risk-based.
Managed Care Review	MC-Review	MC-Review is an online managed care submission portal that streamlines and standardizes the submission of managed care health plan contracts and rates for states and facilitates the intake and review of submissions by Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS).
Prepaid Ambulatory Health Plan	PAHP	Managed care entity that provides a limited benefit package that does not include inpatient hospital or institutional services (examples: dental and transportation) Payment may be risk or non-risk.
Prepaid Impatient Health Plan	PIHP	Managed care entity that provides a limited benefit package that includes inpatient hospital or institutional services (example: mental health) Payment may be risk or non-risk.
Primary Care Case Management	PCCM	Primary care case management entities contract with the state to furnish case management (location, coordination, and monitoring) services Generally, paid fee-for-service for medical services rendered plus a monthly case management fee.
Subject Matter Expert	SME	A SME is a person who is an expert in an area or topic.

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